

ENGLISH FOR NETWORK AND SERVICE TEAMS

Telecommunications English

Keep the service picture clear. Turn technical uncertainty into useful updates.

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Eight lessons. Eleven extended conversations.

INSIDE THE BOOK

192 vocabulary entries / 128 reusable phrases
220 extended-dialogue turns / 11 transfer exchanges
Word banks and explained answer keys

Upper-intermediate to advanced (B2-C1). For network operations, deployment, provisioning, field service, customer care, and vendor-management professionals.

2026 edition

Eight scenarios. Eight skills.

Eight service conversations: coordinate an outage bridge, qualify a fiber handover, investigate busy-hour Wi-Fi, clarify an activation request, prepare a useful dispatch, review an emergency-calling notice, handle repeated interruptions, and compare equipment support horizons.

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Name the service, the evidence, and the next step

Telecommunications teams work across technical, commercial, and customer-facing boundaries. Precise English keeps a reported symptom from becoming an assumed cause, a target from becoming a promise, and a completed task from becoming an approved service.

Separate service impact from root cause

A team can confirm that a service is interrupted before it knows which component caused the interruption. Report each with its own confidence level.

"We have confirmed the affected area; fault isolation is still in progress."

Use identifiers before shorthand

An address may contain several circuits, accounts, or services. Confirm the relevant reference and read it back before arranging changes.

"Which circuit at that address is included in the activation request?"

Distinguish readiness from completion

Installation, inspection, acceptance, provisioning, and activation are different milestones. Name the milestone that the evidence actually supports.

"The installation is complete; acceptance remains pending."

Make the update commitment useful

Give a named owner, a time zone, and the purpose of the next update. Do not turn an update time into a restoration estimate.

"I will update you at 14:00 Eastern, even if the restoration estimate is still unavailable."

PROFESSIONAL BOUNDARIES

All operators, customers, circuits, incidents, dates, prices, contracts, and local procedures are fictional. This book teaches professional English, not network configuration, field-safety procedures, legal compliance, or emergency-call handling. Use approved operating procedures and qualified personnel. Regulatory examples identify their jurisdiction and are not complete compliance instructions.

The next update is not a restoration promise

A Read the situation

Give a concise incident update that separates verified impact, investigation, and a timed communication commitment.

At 09:10, incident 073 interrupts 120 broadband services in the East service area. The number is a count of services, not individual people. Network alarms confirm the interruption, but the cause has not been isolated. No estimated time of restoration has been verified. Network operations lead Arun and customer communications lead Tess join an outage bridge. Their next public update is due at 09:40 Eastern. They need a consistent message without inventing a restoration time or blaming a recent change before evidence connects it to the incident.

PEOPLE / Arun: Network operations lead | Tess: Customer communications lead

URGENCY NEEDS A SHARED STATUS VOCABULARY

On a busy bridge, short statements help only when everyone understands their status. Use confirmed, investigating, and not yet verified consistently. A direct challenge to an unsupported estimate protects the team from repeating a promise it cannot substantiate.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is the verified impact?

A One confirmed faulty router

B 120 broadband services in the East area

C 120 individual people nationwide

D Every service in all areas

2. What does 09:40 Eastern represent?

A The incident start

B The end of customer impact

C The next public update

D A verified restoration time

3. What remains unconfirmed?

A The root cause and restoration estimate

B The incident identifier

C The affected service count

D The 09:10 start time

[Answers and explanations: page 85.](#)

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

NOC

Network operations center; the team or facility monitoring network service.

IN USE notify the NOC

outage bridge

A coordinated call used to manage an interruption.

IN USE join the outage bridge

incident commander

The person coordinating the incident response.

IN USE identify the incident commander

service impact

The effect of an incident on a defined service.

IN USE confirm service impact

blast radius

Informal term for the extent of an incident's effects.

IN USE assess the blast radius

fault isolation

Investigation to locate the source of a fault.

IN USE continue fault isolation

alarm correlation

Analysis of related alerts to find a common pattern.

IN USE perform alarm correlation

root cause

The underlying cause established through investigation.

IN USE verify the root cause

ETR

Estimated time of restoration; a forecast, not automatically a guarantee.

IN USE validate the ETR

restoration

Return of the affected service to its required operating state.

IN USE confirm service restoration

degradation

Reduced performance without necessarily losing the entire service.

IN USE report service degradation

packet loss

Failure of some transmitted data packets to reach their destination.

IN USE measure packet loss

Precision check

An affected-service count is not automatically a count of customers, households, or people. Retain the measurement unit in every update. A shared incident identifier helps different teams discuss the same event without merging unrelated reports.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

latency

Time taken for data to travel through a specified path.

IN USE measure latency

jitter

Variation in packet delay over time.

IN USE monitor jitter

failover

Transfer to an alternative component or path after a problem.

IN USE assess failover status

redundancy

Additional capacity or components intended to improve resilience.

IN USE verify redundancy

workaround

A temporary way to reduce impact without resolving the underlying cause.

IN USE evaluate a workaround

change freeze

A restriction on changes during a defined period.

IN USE observe the change freeze

rollback

Return to a prior configuration or release under an approved process.

IN USE request a rollback

escalation path

The defined route for involving additional authority or expertise.

IN USE follow the escalation path

status cadence

The agreed frequency of updates.

IN USE establish a status cadence

incident timeline

A chronological record of relevant incident events.

IN USE maintain the incident timeline

monitoring window

A defined period for observing service behavior.

IN USE complete the monitoring window

post-incident review

A structured review of the response and underlying learning.

IN USE schedule a post-incident review

Precision check

An ETR is an estimate supported by the available evidence. An update time is a communication commitment. If no estimate is verified, state that clearly and still specify when the next information will be provided.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

OPEN THE UPDATE

"Here is the confirmed service impact."

RETAIN THE UNIT

"We have identified 120 affected broadband services."

REJECT SPECULATION

"The recent change is a lead, not a confirmed cause."

NAME THE NEXT CONTACT

"The next public update is at 09:40 Eastern."

BOUND THE AREA

"The interruption is limited to the East service area in our current evidence."

SEPARATE CAUSE FROM IMPACT

"The interruption is confirmed; the cause is still under investigation."

QUALIFY THE ESTIMATE

"We do not yet have a verified restoration estimate."

PREVENT CONFUSION

"That is an update time, not a restoration commitment."

Current evidence

Limits a statement to what has actually been established.

A lead, not

Distinguishes a useful hypothesis from a verified explanation.

Do not yet

Communicates an information gap without implying that no work is happening.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

ASK FOR A SOURCE

"Which monitoring result supports that statement?"

KEEP THE BRIDGE FOCUSED

"Let us separate current impact from the investigation hypotheses."

RECORD A MILESTONE

"Please add that event and its time to the incident timeline."

KEEP THE MESSAGE ALIGNED

"Customer care and the status page should use the same verified facts."

CHECK A WORKAROUND

"Has the proposed workaround been approved and validated?"

ASSIGN AN OWNER

"Arun will confirm the technical status before the message goes out."

AVOID PREMATURE CLOSURE

"We need the agreed monitoring evidence before closing the incident."

CLOSE THE HANDOVER

"I will circulate the impact, open questions, owner, and next update time."

At ... Eastern

Makes the communication time unambiguous across locations.

Before closing

Names a required dependency instead of assuming the incident is resolved.

Same verified facts

Aligns messages without forcing every channel to use identical wording.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which public line is accurate?

- A** A recent change definitely caused the outage.
- B** Service will be restored at 09:40.
- C** We are investigating an interruption affecting 120 broadband services in the East area.
- D** All East residents have lost every service.

2. A colleague says the recent change caused O73. What is the best response?

- A** Should we remove the change from the investigation until every other cause is excluded?
- B** Can we publish the vendor's first hypothesis as the confirmed cause?
- C** What evidence links that change to this incident?
- D** Can we use the change timestamp alone as the root-cause finding?

3. Which sentence correctly uses ETR?

- A** ETR means the incident has ended.
- B** The public-update deadline guarantees restoration.
- C** No ETR has been verified; the next update is at 09:40 Eastern.
- D** The ETR is simply the time we promised to post.

4. What should the handover preserve?

- A** An unverified component name as root cause
- B** A count of people inferred from services
- C** Impact, open questions, owner, and next update time
- D** Only the most optimistic guess

[Answers and explanations: page 85.](#)

The next update is not a restoration promise

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

monitoring window / service impact / post-incident review / incident commander / Fault isolation / status cadence / ETR / restoration / incident timeline / affected-service count

- 01 **Tess:** Care needs a line for O73 now. They are getting questions about a nationwide outage. What impact can I actually confirm, and what stays open?
- 02 **Arun:** Start with the ¹ _____: 120 broadband services in the East area have been interrupted since 09:10. We have not confirmed an impact outside that area.
- 03 **Tess:** Can I describe that as 120 customers? It sounds more natural in a public notice than a count of services.
- 04 **Arun:** Keep the ² _____. It does not tell us the number of individual people or accounts. We should not convert the figure without a reliable mapping.
- 05 **Tess:** Someone on the call mentioned a change made earlier this morning. Is that the explanation we should give?
- 06 **Arun:** No. ³ _____ is still in progress. The change is one lead, but timing alone does not establish that it caused the interruption.
- 07 **Tess:** Understood. The status page has a field for the expected restoration time. Should I enter our next update time there?
- 08 **Arun:** Leave the ⁴ _____ as unavailable under the page's approved format. Our 09:40 Eastern commitment is to publish an update, not to restore the service.
- 09 **Tess:** I want customers to see that we are actively working on this, even if we cannot give them a finish time.
- 10 **Arun:** We can say the network team is investigating. Set the ⁵ _____ clearly and provide the next time. That is a concrete commitment we can keep while the technical position develops.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 10.

- 11 **Tess:** Can we split the bridge updates? I am hearing a proposed workaround mixed in with confirmed customer impact, and care needs to know which is which.
- 12 **Arun:** I will ask the ⁶ _____ to separate those workstreams. A proposed workaround should not enter the customer message as available before it is approved and validated.
- 13 **Tess:** Who will confirm the technical wording before I send it to the status-page team and customer care?
- 14 **Arun:** I will. Put the current facts in the ⁷ _____ as well, so later updates can show what changed and when.
- 15 **Tess:** If one monitoring screen turns green, can I immediately say that everyone is back online?
- 16 **Arun:** We need the agreed ⁸ _____ and the relevant service checks. One favorable indicator alone does not demonstrate that every affected service has recovered.
- 17 **Tess:** Then the next message may still say we are investigating, but it will have a named owner and a clear time.
- 18 **Arun:** Yes. If the impact changes, describe the ⁹ _____ status precisely. Do not replace an unknown cause with a guess just to make the message feel more complete.
- 19 **Tess:** I will keep the 120-service figure, the East area, the investigation status, and the 09:40 Eastern update commitment together.
- 20 **Arun:** Good. Use that same factual core across channels. After recovery, the ¹⁰ _____ can address the fuller explanation and any follow-up actions.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 86

1. service impact | 2. affected-service count | 3. Fault isolation | 4. ETR | 5. status cadence | 6. incident commander | 7. incident timeline | 8. monitoring window | 9. restoration | 10. post-incident review

Separate a second update from a forecast

F Say it

Incident R16 affects 45 voice services in the North area from 14:05. The next update is at 14:30 Central. The cause and restoration estimate remain unverified.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

unverified / 14:30 Central / R16 / 45 voice services

Lead: "The incident reference is ¹ _____."

Agent: "The verified impact is ² _____."

Lead: "Our next update is at ³ _____."

Agent: "The restoration estimate remains ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 86

1. R16 | 2. 45 voice services | 3. 14:30 Central | 4. unverified

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read turns 1-10; keep the service count and update time separate from people and restoration.
2. Swap roles for turns 11-20; request the evidence needed before announcing recovery.
3. Complete the transfer and retain its service type, area, and time zone.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Installed does not mean accepted

A Read the situation

Describe a construction handover accurately and request the missing acceptance evidence without overstating readiness.

Fiber route F24 is physically installed. The contractor has supplied route photographs and an optical time-domain reflectometer trace, but the agreed handover package also requires an insertion-loss report, updated route drawings, and an inspection sign-off. Those three items remain pending. The next team has scheduled service work on the assumption that the route is accepted. Deployment coordinator Hana and construction lead Victor must correct that assumption. No inspection failure has been reported, but neither installation photographs nor a single test trace establish completion of the agreed acceptance process.

PEOPLE / Hana: Deployment coordinator | Victor: Construction lead

MILESTONE WORDS CARRY OPERATIONAL CONSEQUENCES

One team may use done to mean its own physical task has ended, while another hears permission to proceed. Use the named milestone and list the remaining dependencies. Ask for an owner and evidence instead of assigning blame for the misunderstanding.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which milestone is complete?

- A Service activation
- C Inspection sign-off

- B Physical installation of route F24
- D Full handover acceptance

2. Which item has been supplied?

- A The updated route drawings
- C An OTDR trace

- B The inspection sign-off
- D The insertion-loss report

3. What can be said about inspection?

- A Sign-off is pending; no failure is reported.
- C It is unnecessary because photographs exist.

- B It has definitely failed.
- D It has already authorized service.

Answers and explanations: page 87.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

fiber route

The path followed by an installed fiber cable system.

IN USE identify the fiber route

cable plant

The installed cabling and associated connecting components.

IN USE document the cable plant

as-built drawing

A drawing showing the installation as actually constructed.

IN USE update the as-built drawing

splice enclosure

A protective housing for joined fiber sections.

IN USE identify the splice enclosure

splice schedule

A record of planned or completed fiber connections.

IN USE reconcile the splice schedule

fiber strand

An individual optical fiber within a cable.

IN USE identify the fiber strand

termination

The prepared end connection of a cable or fiber.

IN USE document the termination

patch panel

A panel organizing connections between cables and equipment.

IN USE label the patch panel

OTDR

Optical time-domain reflectometer; an instrument characterizing fiber events using backscattered light and reflections.

IN USE review the OTDR trace

insertion loss

Reduction in optical power through a link or component.

IN USE record insertion loss

loss budget

The planned allowance for optical loss across a link.

IN USE check the loss budget

acceptance criterion

A stated condition that must be met for acceptance.

IN USE confirm the acceptance criteria

Precision check

An OTDR trace helps locate and characterize events along a fiber. It is not a substitute for every required measurement. Here the agreed insertion-loss report remains a separate handover requirement, regardless of how convincing the trace appears.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

test report

A documented account of test methods and results.

IN USE submit the test report

inspection sign-off

Recorded approval following the specified inspection.

IN USE obtain inspection sign-off

handover package

The agreed documents and evidence supplied at transfer.

IN USE complete the handover package

punch list

A recorded list of remaining defects or unfinished items.

IN USE close the punch list

snag

A defect or incomplete item requiring attention.

IN USE record a snag

demarcation point

The defined boundary between service or ownership responsibilities.

IN USE identify the demarcation point

wayleave

Permission to install or maintain infrastructure across another party's land.

IN USE check the wayleave

right of way

A legal or designated right to use a route or corridor.

IN USE confirm the right of way

duct

A protective conduit through which cable is routed.

IN USE identify the duct

pull section

A defined route segment used in cable-installation planning.

IN USE document the pull section

reinstatement

Restoration of disturbed surfaces after construction work.

IN USE inspect the reinstatement

ready for service

A status indicating the specified service-readiness conditions are met.

IN USE verify ready-for-service status

Precision check

Pending means not yet completed or decided. It does not mean failed. Use physically installed, inspection pending, and acceptance pending separately so that a planning team does not infer service readiness from a narrower construction milestone.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

NAME THE COMPLETED TASK

"Physical installation of F24 is complete."

LIST THE SUPPLIED EVIDENCE

"We have photographs and an OTDR trace."

REQUEST THE CURRENT DRAWING

"Please supply the updated as-built route drawing."

SEPARATE THE MEASUREMENTS

"The trace does not replace the agreed loss report."

CORRECT THE STATUS

"The route has not yet been accepted."

IDENTIFY A MISSING ITEM

"The insertion-loss report is still outstanding."

CLARIFY THE INSPECTION

"Inspection sign-off is pending; no failure has been reported."

REFER TO THE AGREEMENT

"Let us check the handover package against the acceptance criteria."

Has not yet

Describes an incomplete milestone without implying permanent failure.

Still outstanding

Identifies a required item that has not been supplied.

Does not replace

Prevents one type of evidence from standing in for a different requirement.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

ASK ABOUT OWNERSHIP

"Who is responsible for each outstanding item?"

QUALIFY DOWNSTREAM PLANNING

"The service work depends on acceptance, not just installation."

CHECK THE BOUNDARY

"Which demarcation point does this report cover?"

ESCALATE THE DEPENDENCY

"I will flag the acceptance gap to the scheduling team."

AVOID A DATE ASSUMPTION

"Do we have confirmed submission dates or only targets?"

CORRECT THE SCHEDULE NOTE

"Please mark the route as installed, acceptance pending."

KEEP EVIDENCE TRACEABLE

"The test result needs the route and fiber identifiers."

CLOSE THE HANDOVER

"We will confirm readiness after the required evidence is reviewed."

Against the criteria

Gives the review a defined reference instead of a general impression.

Depends on

Makes the sequence between milestones explicit.

Targets or confirmed dates

Distinguishes planning intentions from reliable commitments.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which schedule note is supported?

- A** F24 accepted and active.
- B** F24 failed inspection.
- C** F24 requires no further documents.
- D** F24 installed; acceptance pending.

2. What should Hana request?

- A** An acceptance notice based only on the supplied OTDR trace
- B** A confirmed service date before the missing inspection decision is obtained
- C** The missing reports, drawings, and inspection sign-off with owners and dates
- D** The design drawings relabeled as-built without checking changes

3. Which sentence handles the inspection accurately?

- A** Installation automatically closes inspection.
- B** We are awaiting sign-off; no failure has been reported.
- C** Pending always means failed.
- D** A photograph counts as inspector approval.

4. What is the best response to the OTDR argument?

- A** A trace automatically accepts every strand.
- B** We can remove the requirement after the fact.
- C** The trace is useful, but the agreed insertion-loss report is still required.
- D** The two records always measure exactly the same thing.

Answers and explanations: [page 87](#).

Installed does not mean accepted

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

handover package / OTDR / as-built drawing / demarcation point / ready for service / acceptance criteria / inspection sign-off / Insertion loss / fiber strand / fiber route

- 01 **Hana:** F24 is on tomorrow's service schedule. The note just says complete. Does that mean construction has finished, or has the route actually been accepted?
- 02 **Victor:** The ¹ _____ is physically installed. That is what the contractor reported, but I have not issued an acceptance notice for the handover.
- 03 **Hana:** We need to correct the schedule before that wording travels further. What evidence has actually arrived?
- 04 **Victor:** We have photographs and an ² _____ trace. The agreed package also includes an insertion-loss report, updated route drawings, and inspection sign-off. Those three items are still outstanding.
- 05 **Hana:** The contractor says the trace looks good. Does that make the separate loss report a paperwork formality?
- 06 **Victor:** No. ³ _____ is a separate required result in our agreement. We should not treat one type of evidence as a replacement for another because it looks reassuring.
- 07 **Hana:** The current route drawing is the design version. Does the handover need to show the final installed path?
- 08 **Victor:** Yes, we need the ⁴ _____ for the completed installation. If the route or connections changed, the receiving team needs the actual arrangement, not an assumption that the original plan stayed unchanged.
- 09 **Hana:** Is the inspection delayed because something failed, or do we simply not have a recorded decision yet?
- 10 **Victor:** We are awaiting ⁵ _____. No failure has been reported. I would avoid saying passed or failed until we have the inspection record and its actual outcome.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 19.

- 11 **Hana:** Then I should tell the service team that installation is complete but acceptance remains pending.
- 12 **Victor:** Exactly. Ask them to plan against the ⁶ _____, not the contractor's shorthand. We need the outstanding evidence reviewed before anyone turns that status into ready for service.
- 13 **Hana:** Please send an owner and expected date for each missing item. Which dates are firm, and which are still targets?
- 14 **Victor:** I will update the ⁷ _____ tracker with owners and target dates. I will mark a date confirmed only when the responsible person has actually committed to it.
- 15 **Hana:** The test files also need to identify what was measured. There are several fibers and more than one termination point.
- 16 **Victor:** Agreed. Each result needs the route, ⁸ _____, and endpoint references. A technically valid result is still unhelpful if the receiving team cannot match it to the connection they will use.
- 17 **Hana:** I will move the schedule note out of the accepted column and explain the dependency to the next team.
- 18 **Victor:** Use ⁹ _____ only after the required review. That keeps the milestone meaningful and avoids asking the next team to discover the missing records on site.
- 19 **Hana:** I will also keep pending separate from failed. We need to correct the assumption without inventing a construction defect.
- 20 **Victor:** Thank you. Once the evidence is complete, we can confirm the ¹⁰ _____ and the accepted scope together, then notify scheduling with a clear, traceable status.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 88

1. fiber route | 2. OTDR | 3. Insertion loss | 4. as-built drawing | 5. inspection sign-off | 6. acceptance criteria | 7. handover package | 8. fiber strand | 9. ready for service | 10. demarcation point

Check a second handover

F Say it

Route C18 is installed. Its drawings and loss report are supplied, but inspection sign-off is pending. The agreed local process requires that sign-off before acceptance.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

C18 / pending / inspection sign-off / physical installation

Coordinator: "The route identifier is ¹ _____."

Contractor: "The completed milestone is ² _____."

Coordinator: "The outstanding approval is ³ _____."

Contractor: "The acceptance status remains ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 88

1. C18 | 2. physical installation | 3. inspection sign-off | 4. pending

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read turns 1-10; name the supplied evidence and the three outstanding items.
2. Swap roles for turns 11-20; distinguish installation, inspection, and acceptance status.
3. Complete the transfer without converting pending sign-off into a failed inspection.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A signal map cannot explain a busy-hour slowdown

A Read the situation

Compare wireless observations, test a causal claim, and request measurements that distinguish coverage from capacity.

A station concourse provides public Wi-Fi. A coverage map shows signal availability across the seating area. During one quiet-period test, a device achieved 80 megabits per second; during one busy-period test, it achieved 5. The tests do not control for client count, device conditions, interference, or backhaul load. Station manager Mei asks wireless engineer Jordan whether adding access points will solve the problem. Jordan must explain why visible signal does not guarantee usable capacity and why two speed readings alone cannot establish the cause or justify a particular equipment change.

PEOPLE / Mei: Station service manager | Jordan: Wireless engineer

TRANSLATE THE DISTINCTION BEFORE THE ACRONYM

A customer-facing colleague may hear strong signal as good service. Start with the difference between reaching a device and serving its traffic, then introduce the technical measures. Correct an inference without making the person feel foolish for using a coverage map.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What does the coverage map establish here?

A Sufficient backhaul capacity at all times

B Reported signal availability across the seating area

C Guaranteed throughput for every user

D The cause of the busy-hour slowdown

2. What were the two observed speeds?

A 5 Mbps quiet and 80 Mbps busy

B 80 Mbps at both times

C Zero Mbps at both times

D 80 Mbps quiet and 5 Mbps busy

3. What is not yet justified?

A A claim that extra access points will solve the issue

B A request for comparable measurements

C Distinguishing coverage from capacity

D Recording the test times

Answers and explanations: [page 89](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

WLAN

Wireless local-area network, commonly implemented using Wi-Fi.

IN USE assess the WLAN

access point

A device connecting wireless clients to a network.

IN USE identify the access point

coverage

The area in which a usable radio signal is available under stated conditions.

IN USE assess coverage

capacity

The traffic or user demand a system can support under stated conditions.

IN USE assess capacity

throughput

The achieved rate of useful data transfer over a measured interval.

IN USE measure throughput

bandwidth

A frequency range or, in service discussions, a link's nominal data capacity.

IN USE specify the bandwidth

RSSI

Received signal strength indicator; a measure of received radio signal level.

IN USE record RSSI

SNR

Signal-to-noise ratio; signal level compared with background noise.

IN USE measure SNR

airtime

Time during which a shared wireless channel is occupied.

IN USE measure airtime utilization

channel utilization

The proportion of observed time a channel is busy.

IN USE compare channel utilization

co-channel interference

Interference or contention involving devices sharing a channel.

IN USE assess co-channel interference

adjacent-channel interference

Interference involving transmissions on neighboring channels.

IN USE investigate adjacent-channel interference

Precision check

Coverage asks where a signal is available. Capacity asks how much demand the system can support under specified conditions. Throughput is an observed transfer rate. These related terms are not interchangeable, and a coverage map does not guarantee a throughput result.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

client density

The concentration of connected or active devices in an area.

IN USE measure client density

concurrency

Simultaneous activity by multiple users or processes.

IN USE assess peak concurrency

backhaul

The connection carrying traffic onward from an access network.

IN USE check backhaul load

bottleneck

A limiting point that constrains overall performance.

IN USE locate the bottleneck

contention

Competition among devices for a shared transmission resource.

IN USE measure contention

roaming

A client's movement between access points while maintaining connectivity.

IN USE assess roaming behavior

sticky client

Informal term for a client that stays attached to a less suitable access point.

IN USE investigate a sticky client

site survey

A structured assessment of a wireless environment.

IN USE conduct a site survey

heat map

A visual representation of measurements across an area.

IN USE interpret the heat map

busy hour

A defined period of high traffic demand.

IN USE compare busy-hour results

baseline

A reference measurement used for comparison.

IN USE establish a baseline

test condition

A documented circumstance under which a measurement is taken.

IN USE control the test conditions

Precision check

A quiet test and a busy test can reveal a performance difference without identifying its cause. Record device, location, time, client activity, radio conditions, and onward-link load before attributing the change to a particular bottleneck.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

03

ACKNOWLEDGE THE MAP

"The map is useful for signal availability."

NAME ITS LIMIT

"It does not guarantee throughput during peak demand."

STATE THE OBSERVATIONS

"We observed eighty megabits per second in the quiet test and five in the busy test."

KEEP EVIDENCE BOUNDED

"Those are two readings, not a complete performance profile."

EXPLAIN CAPACITY

"More simultaneous demand can compete for the same resources."

AVOID A DIAGNOSIS

"We have not yet isolated the bottleneck."

REQUEST COMPARABLE DATA

"Let us repeat the tests under documented conditions."

ASK ABOUT DEVICES

"Were the device, location, and test method the same?"

Useful for

Acknowledges what a piece of evidence can establish.

Does not guarantee

Blocks an unsupported inference without dismissing the evidence.

Can coexist

Shows that two apparently conflicting observations may both be true.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

03

CHECK RADIO CONDITIONS

"We need signal, noise, and channel-utilization measurements."

QUALIFY THE PROPOSAL

"Extra access points are an option to assess, not a confirmed solution."

SEPARATE TIME PERIODS

"The quiet-period result does not represent the busy hour."

REPORT THE NEXT STEP

"I will bring a comparison of the measurements and likely constraints."

CHECK THE ONWARD PATH

"We should compare backhaul load at the same time."

PREVENT OVERSIMPLIFICATION

"A strong signal can coexist with poor throughput."

ASK FOR THE OBJECTIVE

"What service level are we trying to support in this area?"

CLOSE WITHOUT A PROMISE

"We can recommend a change after the limiting factor is better established."

At the same time

Makes cross-system measurements more comparable.

An option to assess

Presents a possible intervention without claiming it will work.

After ... established

Connects a recommendation to the evidence needed to justify it.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which explanation is most accurate?

- A** Signal availability and busy-hour throughput measure different things.
- B** A coverage map guarantees every speed test.
- C** Strong signal rules out all congestion.
- D** One slow test proves the access point is defective.

2. What should Jordan say about adding access points?

- A** It always increases throughput in proportion to device count.
- B** It makes interference impossible.
- C** It is an option to assess after identifying the constraint.
- D** It will definitely solve the issue.

3. Which comparison is more useful?

- A** Documented tests with radio and backhaul measurements from the same periods
- B** Unlabeled screenshots from different months
- C** A coverage map without traffic observations
- D** Only the fastest quiet-period result

4. What is supported by the two readings?

- A** The coverage map was necessarily false.
- B** Measured throughput differed between the two tests.
- C** Backhaul was certainly the cause.
- D** Every user received exactly five Mbps.

Answers and explanations: [page 89](#).

A signal map cannot explain a busy-hour slowdown

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

throughput / capacity / client density / backhaul / baseline / test conditions / Coverage / airtime / channel utilization / bottleneck

- 01 **Mei:** The map shows signal across the concourse, but the evening team still gets complaints. Is the map missing something, or are we asking it the wrong question?
- 02 **Jordan:** The map answers a narrower question. ¹ _____ tells us something about the radio signal, not everything about the service passengers experience when many devices are active.
- 03 **Mei:** Our quiet test reached eighty megabits per second. In the busy test, the same report shows only five.
- 04 **Jordan:** Those are ² _____ readings under different conditions. They show a performance difference, but we need more context before explaining why that difference occurred.
- 05 **Mei:** I had assumed that a strong signal meant the connection should be fast. What distinction should I use with the station team?
- 06 **Jordan:** Separate signal availability from ³ _____. A device may receive a strong signal while competing with many other devices or encountering a limit elsewhere in the path.
- 07 **Mei:** Purchasing wants to add access points. Before we spend the money, what would show that the extra radios address the actual limit?
- 08 **Jordan:** First we need to locate the ⁴ _____. Extra access points are not automatically the answer, especially if channel conditions or an onward connection are limiting performance.
- 09 **Mei:** What should we collect that the existing map and two speed tests do not tell us?
- 10 **Jordan:** Start with ⁵ _____ and activity during the busy period. We also need the test device, location, method, and time recorded so the comparisons mean something.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

03

Continue with the word bank on page 28.

- 11 **Mei:** The map was produced before the new seating area opened. Could that change the way demand is distributed?
- 12 **Jordan:** It could. We should review ⁶ _____ use across the area, not simply count installed equipment. A changed concentration of active devices may alter how the shared radio resource is used.
- 13 **Mei:** Is interference a definite explanation, or is it another possibility to investigate?
- 14 **Jordan:** It is a possibility. Measurements of signal, noise, and ⁷ _____ can help us distinguish radio conditions from other constraints. We should not name interference as the cause before checking.
- 15 **Mei:** You also mentioned the onward connection. The station team tends to think everything beyond the access point is the same problem.
- 16 **Jordan:** The ⁸ _____ needs attention too. We should compare its load during the same periods, because a limit there can affect users even where the radio signal is adequate.
- 17 **Mei:** Then the eighty-megabit result is useful, but it does not promise that rate at the busiest time.
- 18 **Jordan:** Correct. It is one ⁹ _____, with its conditions attached. We need a comparable busy-period picture rather than treating the fastest observation as a guaranteed service level.
- 19 **Mei:** I will tell purchasing that we are gathering evidence before recommending equipment, and explain the distinction to the station team.
- 20 **Jordan:** Good. I will document the ¹⁰ _____ and bring back the measured constraints. Then we can discuss a targeted change and how its effect would be evaluated.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 90

1. Coverage | 2. throughput | 3. capacity | 4. bottleneck | 5. client density | 6. airtime | 7. channel utilization | 8. backhaul | 9. baseline | 10. test conditions

Describe another wireless comparison

F Say it

A library Wi-Fi test records 60 Mbps at 08:00 and 12 Mbps at 16:00. Signal availability is shown on a map. Client activity and backhaul load have not been measured.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

signal availability / 60 Mbps / 12 Mbps / unconfirmed

Manager: "The 08:00 throughput reading was ¹ _____."

Engineer: "The 16:00 throughput reading was ² _____."

Manager: "The map describes ³ _____."

Engineer: "The cause of the difference remains ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 90

1. 60 Mbps | 2. 12 Mbps | 3. signal availability | 4. unconfirmed

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read turns 1-10; distinguish coverage, capacity, and achieved throughput.
2. Swap roles for turns 11-20; request matched radio and backhaul observations.
3. Complete the transfer and leave the unmeasured cause unconfirmed.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

One address, two circuits, no activation date

A Read the situation

Resolve an incomplete service request through precise identifiers, time references, and a closed-loop read-back.

Order A77 asks for activation at 18 Cedar Plaza but omits the circuit reference and requested date. The site has two services: circuit CP-204 for the ground-floor office and CP-205 for the upstairs studio. During the clarification call, customer coordinator Omar confirms CP-205 and requests 7 October, 18:00-20:00 Eastern. Provisioning specialist Lina has not yet checked resources, approvals, or dependencies. The requested window must be recorded as requested, not confirmed. No one has authorized a change to CP-204, and the conversation does not establish that activation will be interruption-free.

PEOPLE / Omar: Customer service coordinator | Lina: Provisioning specialist

A READ-BACK IS A RELIABILITY TOOL

Repeating a long identifier can feel formal, but it gives both sides a chance to catch a mismatch. Read back the service, location, date, and time zone together. Use requested and confirmed deliberately so politeness does not turn into accidental acceptance.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which circuit does Omar request?

- A Every circuit at Cedar Plaza
- C CP-205 for the upstairs studio

- B An unidentified replacement circuit
- D CP-204 for the ground-floor office

2. What is the status of the 7 October window?

- A Already completed
- C Requested, not yet confirmed

- B Rejected as impossible
- D Approved and guaranteed

3. Which service is outside the stated request?

- A CP-204
- C The upstairs studio service

- B CP-205
- D The service named in A77 after clarification

Answers and explanations: page 91.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

provisioning

Preparing and configuring resources for a specified service.

IN USE coordinate provisioning

activation

Enabling an identified service for use.

IN USE schedule activation

service order

A recorded request for a defined service action.

IN USE validate the service order

circuit reference

An identifier for a particular telecommunications circuit.

IN USE read back the circuit reference

service address

The location associated with the requested service.

IN USE verify the service address

service identifier

A unique reference distinguishing a specific service.

IN USE confirm the service identifier

order validation

Checking that an order is complete and consistent.

IN USE complete order validation

requested date

The date the customer asks for, before confirmation.

IN USE record the requested date

committed date

A date formally confirmed under the applicable process.

IN USE verify the committed date

activation window

The scheduled period for enabling a service.

IN USE confirm the activation window

time zone

The regional time standard used for a schedule.

IN USE state the time zone

dependency

A condition or task that must be satisfied before another proceeds.

IN USE identify the dependency

Precision check

A service address locates the premises; it does not necessarily identify the circuit. Preserve the exact reference when several services share a site. An order number identifies the request, while the circuit reference identifies what the request concerns.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

resource availability

Whether required people, capacity, or equipment are available.

IN USE check resource availability

service profile

The defined configuration or characteristics of a service.

IN USE verify the service profile

port assignment

Allocation of a physical or logical connection point.

IN USE check the port assignment

CPE

Customer premises equipment used at the customer's location.

IN USE verify the CPE details

ONT

Optical network terminal connecting a customer to an optical access network.

IN USE identify the ONT

handoff

The point or process where service or responsibility transfers.

IN USE confirm the handoff

cutover

A planned transition from one service arrangement to another.

IN USE coordinate the cutover

number porting

Transfer of a telephone number between service providers or arrangements.

IN USE confirm number-porting dependencies

portability

The ability to retain a telephone number when changing eligible service arrangements.

IN USE check portability requirements

acceptance test

A defined check used to determine whether a service meets acceptance requirements.

IN USE arrange the acceptance test

order fallout

An order exception that prevents normal processing.

IN USE resolve order fallout

read-back

Repetition of key details to confirm shared understanding.

IN USE perform a read-back

Precision check

Requested and committed dates are different statuses. Repeating a requested window does not confirm it. A successful clarification supplies missing information; the provisioning team must still complete the relevant checks and communicate the actual scheduling decision.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

IDENTIFY THE REQUEST

"I am checking service order A77."

ASK FOR THE EXACT REFERENCE

"Which circuit is included in this request?"

EXCLUDE THE OTHER SERVICE

"CP-204 is outside this request."

COMPLETE THE TIME REFERENCE

"Please include the time zone with the window."

EXPLAIN THE AMBIGUITY

"There are two circuits at that address."

CONFIRM THE LOCATION

"CP-205 serves the upstairs studio."

ASK FOR THE DATE

"What activation date are you requesting?"

READ BACK THE REQUEST

"You are requesting 7 October, 18:00-20:00 Eastern."

Which circuit

Requests an identifier instead of relying on a shared street address.

Included in

Defines the scope of the specific request.

Requesting

Records the customer's preference without promising availability.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

KEEP STATUS CLEAR

"I have recorded that as requested, not confirmed."

AVOID IMPLIED ACCEPTANCE

"This clarification does not yet commit the activation window."

AVOID A CONTINUITY PROMISE

"I cannot confirm an interruption-free change from this information."

REQUEST A CORRECTION

"Please correct any part of that read-back that does not match your request."

NAME THE CHECKS

"We still need to check resources, approvals, and dependencies."

CHECK THE ORDER SCOPE

"Is this activation only, or does the order include a cutover?"

STATE THE NEXT STEP

"I will return the scheduling decision through the order process."

CLOSE WITH A BOUNDARY

"No action on CP-204 is included in the clarified order."

As requested, not confirmed

Explicitly separates information capture from acceptance.

Still need to

Names checks that remain open.

Does not yet commit

Prevents a courteous acknowledgment from becoming a scheduling promise.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which clarification is most useful first?

- A** Can we activate both circuits to save time?
- B** Should we assume the ground floor?
- C** May we omit the circuit field?
- D** Which circuit reference at 18 Cedar Plaza is the request for?

2. Which read-back is correct?

- A** Both services are guaranteed for 7 October.
- B** CP-205 was activated during the call.
- C** A77 requests CP-205 on 7 October, 18:00-20:00 Eastern; confirmation is pending.
- D** CP-204 is approved for immediate activation.

3. What is overpromised?

- A** The requested circuit is CP-205.
- B** The window is not yet confirmed.
- C** There will definitely be no interruption.
- D** We need to check dependencies.

4. What should Lina do after clarification?

- A** Complete the relevant checks and return the scheduling decision.
- B** Treat the customer's preferred date as automatically committed.
- C** Change CP-204 because it shares the address.
- D** Delete the time zone from the order.

Answers and explanations: [page 91](#).

One address, two circuits, no activation date

E Conversations / turns 1-10

04

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

service identifier / time zone / committed date / activation window / circuit reference / read-back / order validation / requested date / service order / dependency

- 01 **Lina:** Can we complete two fields on A77? I have 18 Cedar Plaza, but the site has two circuits and neither the circuit nor requested date is specified.
- 02 **Omar:** Thanks for checking the ¹ _____. We have a ground-floor office and an upstairs studio there. The request concerns the studio, not the office service.
- 03 **Lina:** There are two references on the site record, CP-204 and CP-205. Which one belongs to the studio request?
- 04 **Omar:** The ² _____ is CP-205. CP-204 serves the ground-floor office and should not be included in this activation request.
- 05 **Lina:** I will read that back: CP-205, upstairs studio, at 18 Cedar Plaza. No action on CP-204 is included.
- 06 **Omar:** That ³ _____ is correct. The studio team wants the service available for its new schedule, so they are asking for an evening window.
- 07 **Lina:** What date and time should I record, and which time zone are they using?
- 08 **Omar:** The ⁴ _____ is 7 October. They are asking for 18:00 to 20:00 Eastern, when the studio team can make a contact available.
- 09 **Lina:** I can capture that request, but I have not yet checked the team, capacity, or approvals needed for it.
- 10 **Omar:** Please keep the ⁵ _____ marked as requested. I do not want the studio to read an acknowledgment as confirmation that the work is booked.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

04

Continue with the word bank on page 37.

- 11 **Lina:** Exactly. I also need to check whether the order has any dependencies beyond enabling this service.
- 12 **Omar:** Let me know which ⁶ _____ needs customer input. I can help gather the information, but I should not assume the order has cleared every internal step.
- 13 **Lina:** The address record alone did not tell us whether this was a new activation, a cutover, or a change to both services.
- 14 **Omar:** The ⁷ _____ matters, then. Keep the scope limited to the stated studio request and ask before adding any work involving the office.
- 15 **Lina:** Has anyone promised the studio an interruption-free change? I cannot confirm that from the order, and I want to catch any expectation gap now.
- 16 **Omar:** No. We have not established that. The ⁸ _____ tells us what is involved, but it does not by itself tell us the operational effect of the work.
- 17 **Lina:** I will return the scheduling decision through the order process after checking resources and the remaining approvals.
- 18 **Omar:** Once you have a ⁹ _____, I will pass that exact status to the studio. Until then, I will describe 7 October as our request.
- 19 **Lina:** One final check: A77, CP-205, upstairs studio, 7 October from 18:00 to 20:00 Eastern, with confirmation pending.
- 20 **Omar:** Correct, including the ¹⁰ _____. Please keep CP-204 outside the request, and contact me if any part of the order conflicts with that read-back.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 92

1. service order | 2. circuit reference | 3. read-back | 4. requested date | 5. activation window | 6. dependency | 7. order validation | 8. service identifier | 9. committed date | 10. time zone

Clarify another activation request

F Say it

Order B62 concerns circuit MS-310 at the west office, not MS-311 at the east office. The customer requests 12 October, 09:00-11:00 Pacific. Scheduling checks are incomplete.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

12 October / not yet confirmed / 09:00-11:00 Pacific / MS-310

Specialist: "The requested circuit is ¹ _____."

Coordinator: "The requested date is ² _____."

Specialist: "The requested time window is ³ _____."

Coordinator: "The scheduling status is ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 92

1. MS-310 | 2. 12 October | 3. 09:00-11:00 Pacific | 4. not yet confirmed

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read turns 1-10; read back the circuit, location, date, and requested window.
2. Swap roles for turns 11-20; keep CP-204 outside scope and the date uncommitted.
3. Complete the transfer, including its Pacific time-zone qualifier.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Turn internet bad into a useful ticket

A Read the situation

Elicit observable symptoms, document unknowns, and set accurate expectations for a field-service handoff.

05

Ticket J31 says only internet bad. During a clarification call, customer Erin reports that video calls drop on two Wi-Fi laptops between 18:00 and 20:00. Wired performance has not been checked. The service address is verified through the approved process. Dispatcher Paulo must document the reported pattern without diagnosing a failed router or treating untested wired service as faulty. Erin can provide access from 13:00 to 15:00 on Friday, but that availability has not been booked. A visit, if confirmed, would be an investigation appointment rather than a guarantee of repair within the window.

PEOPLE / Paulo: Service dispatcher | Erin: Customer office coordinator

USE QUESTIONS THAT PRODUCE OBSERVABLE ANSWERS

Customers may describe a service as bad because they do not know the technical distinction. Ask what stops working, on which devices, and when. Repeat their report accurately without turning a customer observation into a confirmed technical diagnosis.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What symptom is reported?

- A** Video calls drop on two Wi-Fi laptops between 18:00 and 20:00.
- C** The router is proven defective.

- B** All wired devices fail all day.
- D** Every application on every device is unavailable.

2. What is unknown?

- A** The ticket number
- C** Whether the two reported devices use Wi-Fi

- B** The reported time range
- D** Wired performance

3. What does Friday 13:00-15:00 represent?

- A** A guaranteed repair completion time
- C** The time the fault occurs

- B** A confirmed technician arrival
- D** Customer availability, not a booked appointment

Answers and explanations: [page 93](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

trouble ticket

A recorded report of a service problem.

IN USE update the trouble ticket

symptom

An observable sign of a problem.

IN USE describe the symptom

intermittent fault

A problem that appears and disappears rather than remaining constant.

IN USE document an intermittent fault

reproducibility

Whether a reported issue can be observed again under stated conditions.

IN USE assess reproducibility

affected device

A device on which a problem has been reported or observed.

IN USE identify affected devices

wired connection

A network connection using a physical cable.

IN USE check wired-connection evidence

wireless connection

A network connection using radio transmission.

IN USE identify the wireless connection

dropout

A temporary loss or interruption of a connection or service.

IN USE report a dropout

symptom window

The time range in which a problem is observed.

IN USE record the symptom window

customer availability

The times a customer can support access or contact.

IN USE confirm customer availability

dispatch

Assignment and coordination of field-service work.

IN USE request dispatch review

work order

An authorized instruction defining service work to be carried out.

IN USE review the work order

Precision check

Customer-reported identifies the source of an observation, not a reason to dismiss it. Record the application, devices, connection type, and time pattern. Do not widen two Wi-Fi laptops into every device or turn unknown wired performance into a confirmed fault.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

appointment window

A scheduled period for the agreed visit or arrival arrangement.

IN USE confirm the appointment window

site access

Permission and practical arrangements for entering the premises.

IN USE arrange site access

access contact

The person coordinating entry to the location.

IN USE identify the access contact

no-access visit

A visit that cannot proceed because required site access is unavailable.

IN USE avoid a no-access visit

remote diagnostics

Investigation using approved tools without an on-site visit.

IN USE review remote diagnostics

line test

A defined check of a telecommunications line's condition or performance.

IN USE review line-test results

fault code

A coded classification or result associated with a reported fault.

IN USE verify the fault code

repeat dispatch

A further field visit for a previously reported issue.

IN USE review repeat-dispatch history

first-time fix

Resolution during the first relevant service visit.

IN USE measure first-time-fix performance

repair authorization

Approval for specified repair work.

IN USE confirm repair authorization

customer-reported

Describes information supplied by the customer rather than independently verified.

IN USE label customer-reported symptoms

closure note

A record explaining the outcome when a ticket is closed.

IN USE complete the closure note

Precision check

Availability is not a booking, and an appointment is not a repair guarantee. Separate the customer access window, the confirmed visit arrangement, the investigation task, and any authorized repair. Avoid promising an outcome before diagnosis and approval.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

OPEN THE CLARIFICATION

"I want to add a clear symptom description to J31."

IDENTIFY THE DEVICES

"Which devices have shown the issue?"

ASK FOR THE PATTERN

"When does the problem usually occur?"

MARK THE UNKNOWN

"Wired performance has not been checked."

ASK ABOUT THE EFFECT

"What stops working when the problem happens?"

IDENTIFY THE CONNECTION

"Are those devices using Wi-Fi or a cable?"

PRESERVE THE OBSERVATION

"You report video-call dropouts on two Wi-Fi laptops."

AVOID A DIAGNOSIS

"That pattern does not yet establish a failed router."

What stops working

Invites an observable description rather than an assumed cause.

Which devices

Narrows the scope of the report.

Has not been checked

Preserves an unknown instead of converting it into a negative result.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

CONFIRM THE SOURCE

"I will label these as customer-reported symptoms."

SEPARATE AVAILABILITY

"I have recorded Friday afternoon as your availability."

CLARIFY THE PURPOSE

"A visit would investigate the reported problem."

PROTECT CREDENTIALS

"Please do not send passwords or one-time security codes in the ticket."

ASK ABOUT ACCESS

"When can someone provide access to the site?"

AVOID A BOOKING ASSUMPTION

"The appointment has not yet been confirmed."

AVOID A REPAIR PROMISE

"The visit window is not a guaranteed repair deadline."

CLOSE THE HANDOFF

"I will pass on the symptoms, unknowns, access contact, and requested availability."

Customer-reported

Attributes the information accurately.

Would investigate

Describes the purpose of a possible visit without claiming a result.

Not a ... deadline

Separates a scheduled contact from an outcome guarantee.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which ticket summary preserves the report?

- A** Router failure confirmed on every device all day.
- B** Wired service is definitely faulty.
- C** Friday afternoon is the fault's only occurrence.
- D** Customer reports video-call drops on two Wi-Fi laptops from 18:00 to 20:00; wired status unknown.

2. Which question provides useful clarification?

- A** Are the affected laptops using Wi-Fi or a cable?
- B** Shall we replace the router before recording which devices fail?
- C** Can we classify wired service as failed because the Wi-Fi calls drop?
- D** Should we record the Friday visit availability as the fault-occurrence window?

3. Which appointment statement is accurate?

- A** The appointment proves the cause.
- B** Friday 13:00-15:00 is your availability; booking is not yet confirmed.
- C** The technician is guaranteed to finish repairs by 15:00.
- D** Offering access automatically books the visit.

4. What should remain marked unknown?

- A** The J31 ticket reference
- B** The reported evening time range
- C** Wired performance
- D** Whether two Wi-Fi laptops were reported

Answers and explanations: [page 93](#).

Turn internet bad into a useful ticket

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

05

WORD + PHRASE BANK

access contact / affected devices / appointment window / work order / symptom window /
customer availability / dispatch / Wired performance / symptom / customer-reported

- 01 **Paulo:** J31 only says internet bad. Could you tell me what stops working and what you have to do to get the call back? I will add the detail for the field team.
- 02 **Erin:** The main ¹ _____ is that video calls drop. We reconnect, but the call sometimes drops again. It is disruptive when the evening team meets customers.
- 03 **Paulo:** Which devices have shown that problem? I do not want to assume it affects everything at the site.
- 04 **Erin:** The ² _____ are two laptops used by that team. Both are on Wi-Fi. I do not have a report about the other devices.
- 05 **Paulo:** Have you observed the same behavior on a wired connection, or is that still unknown?
- 06 **Erin:** ³ _____ has not been checked. I would rather leave that unknown than have the ticket suggest we tested something we did not.
- 07 **Paulo:** That is helpful. Is there a time pattern, or does it happen throughout the day?
- 08 **Erin:** The ⁴ _____ is usually 18:00 to 20:00. That is when these users are making their calls. I cannot say what happens overnight.
- 09 **Paulo:** I will record those details as reported and keep the router diagnosis open. This pattern alone does not identify a failed component.
- 10 **Erin:** Please mark it ⁵ _____. I can describe what the staff experienced, but I do not have a technical test result to attach.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 46.

- 11 **Paulo:** The service address has been verified through our process. Who can arrange entry if a visit is approved?
- 12 **Erin:** I will be the ⁶ _____. I can meet the technician and make sure they reach the area where the two laptops are used.
- 13 **Paulo:** What availability should I send to dispatch? I need to distinguish your preferred time from an appointment we have actually booked.
- 14 **Erin:** Our ⁷ _____ is Friday from 13:00 to 15:00. The evening users will not be there, but I can provide their symptom notes.
- 15 **Paulo:** I have Friday one to three as access availability, not a booking. I will ask scheduling to confirm it and include the evening symptom notes.
- 16 **Erin:** And a confirmed ⁸ _____ would mean an investigation visit, not a guarantee that the connection will be repaired by three. Is that right?
- 17 **Paulo:** Correct. The next step depends on the approved diagnostic process and what the investigation finds. I cannot promise a repair result now.
- 18 **Erin:** Then include the evening pattern in the ⁹ _____ if dispatch proceeds. Otherwise the technician may arrive at a time when the symptom is not visible.
- 19 **Paulo:** I will pass on the two laptops, Wi-Fi connection, evening dropouts, unknown wired status, and your access availability. Do not send passwords in the ticket.
- 20 **Erin:** Thank you. That should make the ¹⁰ _____ more useful. Please send the booking decision separately so our staff do not mistake this clarification call for a confirmed visit.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 94

1. symptom | 2. affected devices | 3. Wired performance | 4. symptom window | 5. customer-reported | 6. access contact | 7. customer availability | 8. appointment window | 9. work order | 10. dispatch

Prepare a second dispatch summary

F Say it

Ticket P28 reports voice-call dropouts on one wired desk phone from 10:00 to 11:00. Other phones have not been checked. The customer offers Monday 15:00-17:00 for access; no booking exists.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

Monday 15:00-17:00 / 10:00-11:00 / one wired desk phone / not checked

Dispatcher: "The affected device is ¹ _____."

Customer: "The reported symptom window is ² _____."

Dispatcher: "Other-phone performance is ³ _____."

Customer: "My access availability is ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 94

1. one wired desk phone | 2. 10:00-11:00 | 3. not checked | 4. Monday 15:00-17:00

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read turns 1-10; ask for observable symptoms rather than a guessed diagnosis.
2. Swap roles for turns 11-20; distinguish the evening symptom window from Friday access.
3. Complete the transfer and keep the unchecked phones separate from the reported device.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Always works is not an approved notice

A Read the situation

Challenge an unsupported service claim and coordinate a clear, service-specific customer notice with the responsible reviewers.

A U.S. interconnected Voice over Internet Protocol provider is preparing a customer notice. The draft says, "911 always works, even without power or broadband." Product records identify dependence on powered customer equipment and a broadband connection, but the draft has not been reviewed against the current applicable requirements or approved service wording. Communications editor Celia and compliance reviewer Marcus must remove the absolute assurance, obtain verified service-specific limitations, and route the notice for review. The task is not to invent a universal disclaimer or conduct an emergency test call.

PEOPLE / Celia: Customer communications editor | Marcus: Compliance reviewer

06

PLAIN LANGUAGE CAN STILL PRESERVE CONDITIONS

Removing jargon should make a limitation easier to understand, not make it disappear. Explain the customer consequence, retain the relevant conditions, and ask the accountable team to verify the wording. A confident tone does not justify an absolute service guarantee.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is wrong with the draft assurance?

- A** It gives an approved service-specific limitation.
- B** It is already reviewed and authorized.
- C** It promises availability despite dependencies identified in the product record.
- D** It includes an unnecessary date.

2. What should happen next?

- A** Publish the assurance because it sounds reassuring.
- B** Invent a universal disclaimer for all services.
- C** Call 911 simply to test the draft.
- D** Verify the limitations and route revised wording through the responsible review process.

3. What jurisdiction and service context are stated?

- A** Only private radio systems
- B** A mobile-only service outside the United States
- C** U.S. interconnected VoIP
- D** Every telephone service worldwide

Answers and explanations: page 95.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

VoIP

Voice over Internet Protocol; voice communication carried over IP networks.

IN USE describe the VoIP service

interconnected VoIP

A regulatory service category connecting IP-based voice with the public telephone network.

IN USE identify interconnected-VoIP obligations

E911

Enhanced 911; emergency calling with associated routing and caller information functions.

IN USE review E911 requirements

PSAP

Public safety answering point; a facility receiving emergency calls.

IN USE identify the relevant PSAP

dispatchable location

Location information sufficient to identify where assistance is needed under applicable rules.

IN USE verify dispatchable-location requirements

registered location

Location information supplied or maintained for a service under applicable arrangements.

IN USE update the registered location

Precision check

VoIP describes a technology family; interconnected VoIP is a specific U.S. regulatory category. Emergency-calling obligations and location arrangements depend on the service and applicable rules. Do not turn one product example into a universal statement about all calling services.

fixed service

A service associated with a fixed location under the relevant definition.

IN USE determine fixed-service requirements

non-fixed service

A service not restricted to a fixed location under the relevant definition.

IN USE review non-fixed-service requirements

nomadic use

Use of a service from changing locations.

IN USE assess nomadic-use implications

power dependency

Reliance on electrical power for service operation.

IN USE disclose the power dependency

broadband dependency

Reliance on a broadband connection for service operation.

IN USE explain the broadband dependency

backup power

An alternative power source intended to support operation during a primary-power loss.

IN USE verify backup-power capabilities

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

service limitation

A condition restricting availability, function, or performance.

IN USE explain a service limitation

customer notification

Information provided to customers about a relevant service matter.

IN USE review the customer notification

affirmative acknowledgment

Active confirmation of specified information; this advisory context requires receipt and understanding.

IN USE record affirmative acknowledgment

prominence

The degree to which important information is noticeable.

IN USE assess the notice's prominence

plain-language notice

A notice using understandable wording while preserving necessary facts.

IN USE prepare a plain-language notice

absolute assurance

An unconditional promise such as always or never.

IN USE remove an absolute assurance

applicability

Whether a requirement covers the specific service or situation.

IN USE assess applicability

approved wording

Language authorized through the responsible review process.

IN USE use approved wording

version control

Identification and management of changes to a document or record.

IN USE maintain version control

compliance review

Assessment against applicable requirements by responsible personnel.

IN USE request compliance review

publication hold

A restriction preventing release until specified conditions are met.

IN USE maintain the publication hold

review record

Documentation of who reviewed which version and the result.

IN USE retain the review record

Precision check

Backup power is not an unlimited guarantee, and local equipment power is only one possible dependency. State verified limitations in clear, prominent language and obtain the appropriate review. This exercise does not provide a complete customer-notification template.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

IDENTIFY THE CLAIM

"The draft says that 911 always works."

STATE THE CONFLICT

"That assurance is not supported by the product record."

06

NAME THE DEPENDENCIES

"The service depends on powered equipment and broadband."

LIMIT THE CONTEXT

"We are reviewing a U.S. interconnected-VoIP service."

ASK FOR CURRENT REQUIREMENTS

"Which current requirements apply to this specific service?"

REQUEST VERIFIED WORDING

"Please confirm the service-specific limitations."

AVOID A UNIVERSAL DISCLAIMER

"We should not reuse a generic notice without checking applicability."

KEEP THE CONSEQUENCE CLEAR

"The customer needs to understand when calling may be limited or unavailable."

Not supported by

Challenges the evidence behind a claim rather than the writer personally.

This specific service

Prevents an example from becoming a universal regulatory statement.

May be limited or unavailable

Describes a possible service consequence without promising a uniform outcome.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

RETAIN PROMINENCE

"The limitation should not disappear into fine print."

CHECK THE VERSION

"Which document version has the reviewer cleared?"

QUESTION THE ABSOLUTE

"Can we substantiate always under the stated conditions?"

ASSIGN THE REVIEW

"Product and compliance need to verify the technical facts and applicable language."

SEPARATE REVIEW FROM RELEASE

"A revised draft is not yet approved for publication."

RECORD THE DECISION

"Please retain the review outcome with the approved text."

PROTECT EMERGENCY RESOURCES

"We are not making an emergency call to test this wording."

CLOSE THE RELEASE CONDITION

"Keep the notice on hold until the responsible review is complete."

06

Not yet approved

Distinguishes editing progress from release authorization.

Which version

Makes approval traceable to an exact document.

Until ... complete

States the condition for ending the publication hold.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which revision approach is appropriate?

- A** Replace the absolute with verified service-specific limitations and obtain review.
- B** Add always in bold type.
- C** Copy a disclaimer from an unrelated service.
- D** Hide the limitation in unreadable text.

2. Which statement should be challenged?

- A** The draft needs service-specific review.
- B** The applicable service category matters.
- C** Backup power means emergency calling can never fail.
- D** Equipment power is a dependency to verify.

3. What does an approved wording record need?

- A** An approval email that does not identify which of the two drafts was reviewed
- B** A cleared headline applied to a later, changed notice without checking scope
- C** Product approval alone when the stated process also requires compliance review
- D** The exact version and documented review outcome

4. What does this scenario authorize?

- A** Review of customer-notice language, not an emergency test call
- B** An uncoordinated call to 911
- C** Publication before review
- D** A universal promise for every VoIP service

Answers and explanations: [page 95](#).

Always works is not an approved notice

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

absolute assurance / backup power / service limitation / plain-language notice / approved wording / applicability / review record / prominence / version control / publication hold

06

- 01 **Celia:** Can we hold this notice? The headline promises 911 always works without power or broadband, but the product notes list both as dependencies.
- 02 **Marcus:** It is an ¹ _____ that our product record does not support. We need to stop that version from being published while we verify the relevant service facts.
- 03 **Celia:** The product notes say the customer equipment requires power and the voice service uses a broadband connection. Neither dependency appears in the draft.
- 04 **Marcus:** Then each ² _____ needs to be explained accurately. Reassurance should come from useful information, not from deleting conditions that may affect whether the service works.
- 05 **Celia:** Can I take a standard paragraph from another provider and replace the product name? That would be quicker than starting again.
- 06 **Marcus:** First check ³ _____. We are dealing with a U.S. interconnected-VoIP service, and the actual product, location arrangements, and current requirements matter. Another service's paragraph may not fit.
- 07 **Celia:** I want the revised notice to be understandable without asking customers to decode technical language.
- 08 **Marcus:** A ⁴ _____ can say what customers need to know about possible limitations. Product staff must verify the facts, and the responsible reviewers must check the resulting wording.
- 09 **Celia:** Should we say that a battery solves the problem? Some equipment has backup-power options.
- 10 **Marcus:** Do not infer a guarantee from ⁵ _____. We need verified capabilities and conditions. Power at one device does not automatically establish that every part of the calling path remains available.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 55.

- 11 **Celia:** The limitation is in a small note below the reassurance. Please review the layout too; changing the paragraph will not help if the headline still contradicts it.
- 12 **Marcus:** We need to assess ⁶ _____ as well as wording. A clear sentence loses value if the layout makes it easy to miss or the headline contradicts it.
- 13 **Celia:** I will remove the always statement, list the questions for product, and send the replacement draft through the review process.
- 14 **Marcus:** Keep the ⁷ _____ in place. A better draft is progress, but it is not the same thing as a document cleared for customer release.
- 15 **Celia:** We have two versions circulating. One has the old headline and the other has my changes. That could become confusing.
- 16 **Marcus:** Use ⁸ _____ and retire the old release copy from the active workflow. The review should point to an exact version, not a vague reference to the latest draft.
- 17 **Celia:** I will ask product to verify the limitations and compliance to identify the current requirements, including the relevant customer-notification process.
- 18 **Marcus:** Yes. Retain the ⁹ _____. Do not describe our edited paragraph as a complete compliance solution before those checks and any associated process requirements are addressed.
- 19 **Celia:** And we are reviewing language, not asking staff to call emergency services to see what happens.
- 20 **Marcus:** Correct. Once the responsible process is complete, use the ¹⁰ _____ for this service. Keep the customer consequence clear and do not restore an unsupported promise for a more reassuring tone.

06

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 96

1. absolute assurance | 2. service limitation | 3. applicability | 4. plain-language notice | 5. backup power | 6. prominence | 7. publication hold | 8. version control | 9. review record | 10. approved wording

Track a notice through review

F Say it

Draft N8 says a voice service never fails. Product records identify a power dependency. The local release process requires product and compliance approval. Neither team has approved N8.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

06

WORD + PHRASE BANK

not approved / never fails / power dependency / product and compliance

Editor: "The unsupported absolute is ¹ _____."

Reviewer: "The identified technical condition is a ² _____."

Editor: "The required reviewers are ³ _____."

Reviewer: "The release status is ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 96

1. never fails | 2. power dependency | 3. product and compliance | 4. not approved

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read turns 1-10; explain why the absolute claim conflicts with the known dependencies.
2. Swap roles for turns 11-20; keep prominence, version, and review status explicit.
3. Complete the transfer as a notice review, without making an emergency test call.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A retention conversation without a false guarantee

A Read the situation

Acknowledge repeated disruption, offer accountable follow-up, and distinguish service recovery from unsupported retention promises.

Business customer Leila reports three broadband interruptions this week and is considering cancellation. The service is currently working, but the incident records do not yet establish a single shared cause. Account specialist Mateo can coordinate a technical review and provide a named update at 16:00 Central the next day. A service-credit request may be reviewed under the actual contract and applicable requirements; no amount is approved. Leila wants a guarantee that the problem will never recur. Mateo must respond honestly and preserve access to the cancellation process rather than making support conditional on staying.

PEOPLE / Leila: Business customer | Mateo: Account specialist

07

ACKNOWLEDGE THE COST WITHOUT PROMISING THE IMPOSSIBLE

A customer may need recognition of operational disruption before hearing the technical explanation. Name the repeated impact, then offer specific ownership and timing. Avoid using a sympathetic tone to smuggle in a promise about cause, compensation, or future reliability.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What has Leila reported?

- | | |
|--|--|
| A Continuous service loss at the moment | B An approved credit amount |
| C Three broadband interruptions this week | D Three proven failures of the same component |

2. What can Mateo commit to?

- | | |
|---|---|
| A Automatic resolution before the update | B A coordinated review and an update at 16:00 Central the next day |
| C A guarantee that interruption will never recur | D An already approved credit |

3. What should happen if Leila wants to cancel?

- | | |
|---|---|
| A Require her to withdraw the request before receiving help. | B Claim cancellation is impossible without checking terms. |
| C Promise a credit only if she stops asking questions. | D Provide the applicable cancellation route without withholding support. |

Answers and explanations: [page 97](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

churn

Customer loss over a defined period or the process of leaving a service.

IN USE analyze customer churn

retention

Efforts to maintain an ongoing customer relationship.

IN USE handle a retention conversation

service recovery

Actions taken to address a poor service experience.

IN USE coordinate service recovery

repeat incident

A further incident involving a previously affected customer or service.

IN USE review repeat incidents

recurrence

The return of a problem after an earlier occurrence.

IN USE investigate recurrence

common cause

A cause shared by multiple events.

IN USE establish a common cause

impact statement

A concise account of the customer's operational consequences.

IN USE record the impact statement

case owner

The person accountable for coordinating a case.

IN USE name the case owner

follow-up commitment

A specific promise about a later action or contact.

IN USE record the follow-up commitment

service credit

A contract-related adjustment for eligible service performance issues.

IN USE review a service-credit request

goodwill adjustment

A discretionary commercial adjustment offered under applicable authority.

IN USE request a goodwill adjustment

eligibility

Whether the conditions for a process or benefit are met.

IN USE assess credit eligibility

Precision check

Three interruptions establish a repeated customer experience, not necessarily one recurring technical fault. Say the records are being compared until a common cause is supported. Service currently working does not erase earlier disruption or establish that recurrence is impossible.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

SLA

Service-level agreement; defined service commitments and associated terms.

IN USE review the SLA

availability

The extent to which a service is usable during a defined measurement period.

IN USE measure service availability

downtime

Time during which a defined service is unavailable.

IN USE reconcile downtime records

exclusion

A circumstance left outside a specified contractual provision.

IN USE check the exclusions

remediation plan

A planned set of actions to address an identified problem.

IN USE confirm the remediation plan

cancellation request

A customer's request to end a service.

IN USE record the cancellation request

notice period

The time required between a notice and its effective action under applicable terms.

IN USE verify the notice period

termination charge

A charge that may apply when ending a contract under specified conditions.

IN USE check the termination charge

complaint escalation

Referral of a complaint to a further review level.

IN USE explain the complaint escalation route

relationship risk

The likelihood or consequence of damage to an ongoing customer relationship.

IN USE assess relationship risk

service history

The record of service events and interactions over time.

IN USE review the service history

reliability claim

A statement about a service's dependable operation.

IN USE substantiate a reliability claim

Precision check

A service credit and a goodwill adjustment can follow different rules and approval routes. Record the request accurately without promising eligibility or an amount. Explain the actual cancellation and complaint processes without making support conditional on retention.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE REPETITION

"Three interruptions in one week have disrupted your team."

SEPARATE PRESENT STATUS

"The connection is working now, but that does not resolve your concern."

DECLINE THE GUARANTEE HONESTLY

"I cannot promise that an interruption will never happen again."

MAKE THE UPDATE SPECIFIC

"I will update you tomorrow at 16:00 Central."

RECOGNIZE THE CONSEQUENCE

"I understand why you are questioning the service."

AVOID A COMMON-CAUSE ASSUMPTION

"We have not yet established that all three incidents share one cause."

OFFER OWNERSHIP

"I will coordinate the review and remain your contact."

PRESERVE THE DISTINCTION

"That is a progress update, not a guaranteed resolution time."

Working now, but

Acknowledges current recovery without minimizing the prior impact.

Not yet established

Keeps a causal claim open until evidence supports it.

I cannot promise

Gives an honest limit instead of an impossible assurance.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

CAPTURE THE CREDIT REQUEST

"I will submit the service-credit request for review."

SEPARATE COMMERCIAL ROUTES

"A goodwill adjustment is not the same as an SLA credit."

AVOID A CONDITION

"You do not need to withdraw the complaint to receive support."

EXPLAIN ESCALATION

"I will provide the applicable complaint-review route."

QUALIFY THE OUTCOME

"Eligibility and any amount remain unconfirmed."

RESPECT THE CUSTOMER'S CHOICE

"I can explain the cancellation route while the review continues."

ASK FOR EVIDENCE

"Let us compare the incident times with the service history."

CLOSE WITH ACCOUNTABILITY

"You will receive the review status, open questions, and next actions at the agreed time."

I will coordinate

Offers a concrete action within the speaker's control.

For review

Records a request without granting its outcome.

While ... continues

Allows parallel support and customer-choice processes.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which response best handles never again?

- A** I guarantee no future interruption under any conditions.
- B** We cannot help unless you stay.
- C** Three incidents prove one cause, so there is nothing to review.
- D** I cannot guarantee that, but I will coordinate the review and update you tomorrow at 16:00 Central.

2. Which credit statement is accurate?

- A** Every interruption automatically earns the same credit.
- B** A goodwill adjustment and SLA credit are always identical.
- C** I will submit the request; eligibility and amount remain unconfirmed.
- D** Your full monthly fee is already approved for refund.

3. What should the technical summary say?

- A** The same router caused all three incidents.
- B** Current operation proves the previous reports were false.
- C** Every future interruption is impossible.
- D** Three interruptions are reported; a shared cause is not yet established.

4. How should cancellation be handled?

- A** Make all technical support conditional on retention.
- B** Explain the applicable route while continuing the review.
- C** Withhold the route until the customer withdraws the complaint.
- D** Invent a notice period to discourage departure.

Answers and explanations: [page 97](#).

A retention conversation without a false guarantee

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

complaint escalation / service credit / goodwill adjustment / case owner / reliability claim / service recovery / cancellation request / follow-up commitment / common cause / service history

07

- 01 **Leila:** Three interruptions this week have meant rearranging customer calls again and again. I am considering moving. What will be different about this follow-up?
- 02 **Mateo:** I understand the ¹ _____ needs to be more than an apology. Three interruptions have affected your work, even though the connection is operating at the moment.
- 03 **Leila:** The last person said it was fixed. Why should I trust another explanation if the same thing keeps happening?
- 04 **Mateo:** We need to compare the ² _____ before calling it the same technical fault. The repeated impact is clear, but the records do not yet establish one common cause.
- 05 **Leila:** Please give me one contact who has all three records. Each time I call, I seem to be starting from the first interruption.
- 06 **Mateo:** I will be the ³ _____ for the coordinated review. I will link the three incident records and make sure the technical team sees the times and the effect on your business.
- 07 **Leila:** Can you guarantee that it will never happen again? That is the assurance I need before deciding to stay.
- 08 **Mateo:** I cannot make that ⁴ _____. I can promise a defined review and communication, but it would be misleading to guarantee that no interruption could ever occur.
- 09 **Leila:** Then tell me exactly when I will hear from you and what that contact will contain.
- 10 **Mateo:** My ⁵ _____ is tomorrow at 16:00 Central. I will provide the review status, any verified findings, the questions still open, and the next actions.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 64.

- 11 **Leila:** We have lost time dealing with this. I also want the charges reviewed, not just the technical records.
- 12 **Mateo:** I will submit a ⁶ _____ request under the actual agreement and applicable requirements. I cannot confirm eligibility or an amount before that review has taken place.
- 13 **Leila:** Someone mentioned a goodwill payment. Is that the same thing as a credit under the service agreement?
- 14 **Mateo:** A ⁷ _____ can follow a different approval route. I will keep the requests distinct so that we do not imply one decision automatically resolves the other.
- 15 **Leila:** I still want the cancellation information. I do not want to be told I must stay before anyone investigates.
- 16 **Mateo:** I will provide the applicable ⁸ _____ process while the review continues. You do not have to withdraw the complaint to receive support, and I will not invent terms to discourage your decision.
- 17 **Leila:** That is clearer. Please do not send a message saying the root cause is confirmed unless the technical team can support it.
- 18 **Mateo:** Agreed. We will describe a ⁹ _____ only if the evidence connects the events. If the review is still incomplete at the update time, I will say that and explain what remains.
- 19 **Leila:** I will expect your update tomorrow at four Central, with the technical status and the separate credit-review status.
- 20 **Mateo:** Yes, and I will include the ¹⁰ _____ route if you want that review. My update commitment stands whether you decide to retain the service or proceed with cancellation.

07

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 98

1. service recovery | 2. service history | 3. case owner | 4. reliability claim | 5. follow-up commitment | 6. service credit | 7. goodwill adjustment | 8. cancellation request | 9. common cause | 10. complaint escalation

State a bounded recovery commitment

F Say it

Customer Nera reports two interruptions. Agent Sol owns the review and promises an update on Tuesday at 11:00 Mountain. The shared cause and any service credit remain undecided.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

Sol / Tuesday at 11:00 Mountain / undecided / two

Agent: "The reported number of interruptions is ¹ _____."

Customer: "The named review owner is ² _____."

Agent: "The next update is ³ _____."

Customer: "The credit outcome remains ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 98

1. two | 2. Sol | 3. Tuesday at 11:00 Mountain | 4. undecided

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read turns 1-10; acknowledge the repeated impact and give a bounded commitment.
2. Swap roles for turns 11-20; separate technical, credit, and cancellation processes.
3. Complete the transfer with the named owner and the exact update time.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

The cheaper purchase leaves a two-year support gap

A Read the situation

Compare procurement options across a common planning horizon and explain the limits of a headline-price comparison.

A team plans to operate new network equipment through 31 December 2030. Fictional Model A costs \$40,000 and its published last date of support is 31 December 2028. Model B costs \$50,000 and support runs through 31 December 2031. The quotations contain no migration, maintenance, training, or disposal estimates. Procurement lead Zara favors A because it saves \$10,000 at purchase. Network planner Noah must explain A's 24-month support gap during 2029-2030, while making clear that B's longer support horizon does not by itself establish the lower total cost or prove every required feature is suitable.

PEOPLE / Zara: Procurement lead | Noah: Network lifecycle planner

08

COMPARE THE DECISION, NOT JUST THE PRICE

A procurement colleague may be correctly reporting a purchase saving while omitting a later exposure. Acknowledge the saving, then compare both options over the same operating period. Avoid replacing one incomplete argument with an equally unsupported claim that the more expensive option must be better.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is Model A's purchase-price advantage?

A \$50,000

B No difference

C \$10,000

D \$24,000

2. How long is A's support gap within the plan?

A 24 months during 2029-2030

B 12 months during 2031

C No gap

D 60 months during 2026-2030

3. What remains unknown?

A B's published support end date

B The planned operating end date

C The complete total cost of either option

D A's quoted purchase price

Answers and explanations: page 99.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

equipment lifecycle

The sequence from acquisition through operation and retirement.

IN USE plan the equipment lifecycle

end-of-sale

The milestone after which a product is no longer sold through the specified channel.

IN USE check the end-of-sale notice

end-of-life

A vendor-defined lifecycle phase with associated milestone dates.

IN USE review the end-of-life announcement

LDOS

Last date of support; the final support milestone specified by the vendor.

IN USE verify the LDOS

support horizon

The period through which the applicable support remains available.

IN USE compare support horizons

support gap

A period of intended operation beyond available applicable support.

IN USE quantify the support gap

planning horizon

The period covered by the decision or operating plan.

IN USE align the planning horizon

purchase price

The initial amount paid to acquire an item.

IN USE compare purchase prices

TCO

Total cost of ownership across a defined scope and time period.

IN USE estimate TCO

maintenance cost

The cost of keeping equipment in its intended operating condition.

IN USE estimate maintenance costs

migration cost

The cost of moving from one system or arrangement to another.

IN USE scope migration costs

training cost

The cost of preparing staff to use or support a system.

IN USE include training costs

Precision check

End-of-sale and last date of support are different milestones. A product may remain supported after sales end, or continue operating after support ends. Continued operation does not demonstrate support entitlement, security-update availability, or an acceptable risk decision.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

disposal cost

The cost of retiring, removing, or disposing of equipment appropriately.

IN USE estimate disposal costs

residual value

Estimated value remaining at the end of a defined period.

IN USE assess residual value

support entitlement

The specific support rights provided by applicable terms.

IN USE verify support entitlement

renewal

Extension or replacement of a contract under agreed terms.

IN USE review renewal conditions

security update

A software change addressing security issues.

IN USE verify security-update availability

firmware

Software embedded in or closely associated with a device.

IN USE review firmware support

spares strategy

A plan for obtaining and holding replacement components.

IN USE establish a spares strategy

interoperability

The ability of systems or components to work together as required.

IN USE test interoperability

technical fit

How well a product meets the stated technical requirements.

IN USE assess technical fit

exit plan

A plan for leaving a system or supplier arrangement.

IN USE prepare an exit plan

risk acceptance

An authorized decision to take a defined risk under the organization's process.

IN USE document risk acceptance

decision record

Documentation of a choice, its evidence, assumptions, and approval.

IN USE maintain the decision record

Precision check

A \$10,000 purchase saving is not a \$10,000 total-cost saving unless the remaining cost comparison supports it. Use the same planning horizon and scope for both options. A contract renewal should not be assumed to extend a published hardware-support boundary.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE THE SAVING

"Model A is ten thousand dollars cheaper to purchase."

STATE THE SUPPORT BOUNDARY

"Model A's last date of support is 31 December 2028."

SEPARATE MILESTONES

"End-of-sale is not the same as last date of support."

LIST MISSING COSTS

"We still need migration, maintenance, training, and disposal estimates."

ALIGN THE HORIZON

"Our operating plan runs through 31 December 2030."

QUANTIFY THE GAP

"That leaves twenty-four months beyond support within our plan."

AVOID A COST SHORTCUT

"Purchase price alone does not establish total cost."

QUALIFY THE ALTERNATIVE

"Model B covers the stated support horizon, but technical fit still needs checking."

08

Cheaper to purchase

Restricts the saving claim to the known initial cost.

Within our plan

Connects the support gap to the decision's actual time horizon.

Still need

Identifies missing evidence instead of filling it with assumptions.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

CHECK THE ACTUAL TERMS

"What support entitlement does this quotation include?"

AVOID AN OPERATING INFERENCE

"Equipment still running is not the same as equipment still supported."

KEEP RISKS VISIBLE

"The support gap needs a documented response or authorized risk decision."

REQUEST A COMPARABLE ESTIMATE

"Please cost both options over the same period."

CHALLENGE AN ASSUMPTION

"Do we have written confirmation that renewal changes the support boundary?"

ASK ABOUT THE TRANSITION

"What would a supported replacement require before the deadline?"

SEPARATE PRICE FROM SUITABILITY

"A higher price does not prove that every requirement is met."

CLOSE THE DECISION RECORD

"Record the dates, costs, missing evidence, and approving owner together."

Does not establish

Blocks a conclusion stronger than the supplied facts.

Written confirmation

Requests traceable evidence for an important contractual claim.

Same period

Makes the cost comparison fair and interpretable.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which financial claim is supported?

- A** A costs \$10,000 less to purchase; total-cost savings are not established.
- B** A has a proven \$10,000 lower total cost.
- C** B is automatically the cheapest over its lifetime.
- D** Support dates have no relevance to the plan.

2. Which statement describes the gap correctly?

- A** A has only one unsupported month.
- B** A is beyond its stated support date for all of 2029 and 2030.
- C** A is supported throughout the plan.
- D** B loses support before the plan ends.

3. What should be checked before relying on renewal?

- A** Only whether a purchase order can be raised
- B** Whether the equipment still powers on
- C** A salesperson's vague statement without terms
- D** The applicable product notice and written support terms

4. What remains necessary for Model B?

- A** No further assessment because it costs more
- B** A claim that support dates prove performance
- C** Automatic purchase without approval
- D** Technical-fit and full-cost assessment

Answers and explanations: page 99.

The cheaper purchase leaves a two-year support gap

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

exit plan / purchase price / TCO / decision record / support gap / interoperability / support horizon / LDOS / migration cost / support entitlement

08

- 01 **Zara:** A saves ten thousand at purchase. Before I recommend it, show me the support gap against our operating plan, not just a general end-of-life warning.
- 02 **Noah:** The ¹ _____ difference is real. Before deciding, we should compare the support dates against our plan to operate the equipment through the end of 2030.
- 03 **Zara:** A's notice says support ends on 31 December 2028. The equipment should still be able to run after that, though.
- 04 **Noah:** Running and supported are different. The ² _____ tells us the support boundary, not the date the equipment necessarily stops functioning. Our plan extends two years beyond that boundary for A.
- 05 **Zara:** So you are identifying the whole of 2029 and 2030, rather than a short gap at the end of the project.
- 06 **Noah:** Yes, a twenty-four-month ³ _____ within the current plan. We need a response to that gap, whether it involves a supported replacement or an authorized risk decision.
- 07 **Zara:** The buyer suggested renewing in 2028. Do the actual terms extend this equipment's support, or would we still face the same end date?
- 08 **Noah:** We need to verify the ⁴ _____. Do not assume renewal extends a published hardware-support boundary. We need the applicable notice and written terms before relying on that option.
- 09 **Zara:** Model B's support date is 31 December 2031, so it covers the operating period we are discussing.
- 10 **Noah:** Its ⁵ _____ does cover that period. That is a useful advantage, but it does not prove B meets every technical requirement or has the lowest complete cost.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 73.

- 11 **Zara:** I do not want the comparison to become an automatic recommendation for the more expensive product.
- 12 **Noah:** Nor do I. We need ⁶ _____ over the same period for both. The quotations do not yet include migration, maintenance, training, or disposal, so a total-cost conclusion would be premature.
- 13 **Zara:** If A requires replacement before support ends, that transition could use some of the initial saving.
- 14 **Noah:** Exactly, but we must estimate the ⁷ _____ rather than invent it. The amount, timing, staff effort, and service implications need a scoped comparison.
- 15 **Zara:** We should also check whether both models work with the equipment and management tools we already use.
- 16 **Noah:** That is the ⁸ _____ assessment. A support date and a price do not answer whether the product fits the required environment or needs additional changes.
- 17 **Zara:** I will ask for comparable cost estimates and confirmation of the support terms. How should I describe the unresolved risk for A?
- 18 **Noah:** State the twenty-four-month gap and the missing ⁹ _____. Avoid labeling the saving as a complete business benefit until the transition or risk response is costed and reviewed.
- 19 **Zara:** Then the decision is not simply forty versus fifty thousand. It includes support coverage, technical suitability, and the costs we have not obtained.
- 20 **Noah:** Correct. Put those facts and open assumptions in the ¹⁰ _____. We can make a defensible recommendation once the comparison is complete, without pretending either price alone settles it.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 100

1. purchase price | 2. LDOS | 3. support gap | 4. support entitlement | 5. support horizon | 6. TCO | 7. migration cost | 8. interoperability | 9. exit plan | 10. decision record

Compare another support horizon

F Say it

A plan runs through 31 December 2032. Model C costs \$24,000 with support ending 31 December 2031. Model D costs \$29,000 with support through 2033. Other lifecycle costs are unknown.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

Model D / 12 months / not established / \$5,000

08

Buyer: "Model C's initial price advantage is ¹ _____."

Planner: "C's support gap within the plan is ² _____."

Buyer: "The model covering the stated support horizon is ³ _____."

Planner: "The complete total-cost comparison is ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 100

1. \$5,000 | 2. 12 months | 3. Model D | 4. not established

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read turns 1-10; compare both support dates with the same operating horizon.
2. Swap roles for turns 11-20; distinguish the purchase saving from a complete cost estimate.
3. Complete the transfer and identify the unsupported year within the plan.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

The call connects, but audio is one-way

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Describe voice-call evidence by protocol, direction, and observation point without closing the fault prematurely.

Fictional authorized test S42: an office agent hears the external caller, but the caller reports no agent audio. SIP INVITE receives 200 OK and is acknowledged. An approved office-edge trace shows outbound RTP packets; remote receipt and playback are unverified. No cause is established. This is a coordination discussion, not configuration instructions or an emergency-call test.

PEOPLE / Dina: Enterprise voice engineer | Marco: Carrier support engineer

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

09

WORD + PHRASE BANK

one-way audio / fault summary / codec / RTP / media path / SIP signaling

- 01 **Dina:** S42 connects, but the caller cannot hear our agent. Our agent can hear the caller. The ticket was marked successful because the setup trace looked normal.
- 02 **Marco:** The ¹ _____ completed for this call. That is useful evidence about setup, not proof that both audio directions worked.
- 03 **Dina:** Then please keep the fault open. I want the summary to say which person hears which, rather than just audio problem.
- 04 **Marco:** Agreed. We have ² _____ from the user's perspective. Caller to office is audible; office to caller is reported inaudible.
- 05 **Dina:** At the office edge, the approved trace shows outbound packets for the test. Does that establish that our voice reached the caller?
- 06 **Marco:** It establishes packets at that observation point. ³ _____ traffic leaving the edge is not the same as confirmed receipt and successful playback at the far end.
- 07 **Dina:** So we still need to correlate that stream with the carrier-side evidence. I will include the exact test time and the local call reference.
- 08 **Marco:** Please include the time zone and trace point as well. If clocks differ or we compare another attempt, the packet observations may appear inconsistent for the wrong reason.
- 09 **Dina:** The report should not say zero packet loss at the caller. We have not measured the caller's receiving side at all.
- 10 **Marco:** Correct. The ⁴ _____ needs investigation in the affected direction. We cannot infer every hop from a successful setup exchange.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 76.

- 11 **Dina:** Someone has suggested a firewall issue. I have left that as a hypothesis, because we have not located where the useful audio stops.
- 12 **Marco:** That is appropriate. Address translation, media negotiation, endpoint behavior, and other causes may need checking under the approved process. Naming a familiar cause is not isolation.
- 13 **Dina:** Would a stream of packets also be consistent with silence or an endpoint failing to render audio, rather than packets disappearing in transit?
- 14 **Marco:** Yes. Packet presence does not prove the intended speech was encoded or played. The negotiated ⁵ _____ and endpoint behavior may matter, but neither is established as the fault here.
- 15 **Dina:** We should avoid copying customer audio or full account details into the general ticket. The authorized technical record should contain only what the investigation needs.
- 16 **Marco:** Agreed. Use the approved access and retention process. I will ask the carrier team for correlated observations, not a blanket assertion that everything beyond our boundary is fine.
- 17 **Dina:** My update will say setup completed, caller-to-office audio works in this test, and the opposite direction still needs investigation beyond the local packet observation.
- 18 **Marco:** That is an accurate ⁶ _____. Include the test reference so the next engineer does not merge it with a different customer attempt.
- 19 **Dina:** Once a correction is made, we should repeat the agreed ordinary test and verify speech in both directions, not just look for another 200 OK.
- 20 **Marco:** Yes. The closure record needs the actual end-to-end result and any remaining limitations. For now, S42 is connected at the signaling level but not a verified successful voice conversation.

09

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 101

1. SIP signaling | 2. one-way audio | 3. RTP | 4. media path | 5. codec | 6. fault summary

Reverse the affected direction

F Say it in a new situation

Fictional test T19: the external caller hears the office agent, but the agent cannot hear the caller. Call setup succeeds. Packets are observed at the caller-side edge only; office receipt and playback are unchecked.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

unchecked / audio / T19 / office

09

Engineer: The reported inaudible direction is caller to ¹ _____.

Support: Successful setup establishes signaling, not end-to-end
² _____.

Engineer: Office-side receipt is still ³ _____.

Support: Keep the record tied to test ⁴ _____.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 101

1. office | 2. audio | 3. unchecked | 4. T19

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.
2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.
3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

Enough light, but not enough margin

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Explain a fiber power calculation while distinguishing absolute power, link loss, and the required design reserve.

Fictional matching optical equipment: minimum transmit power -3 dBm; receiver sensitivity -20 dBm at the specified performance. Planned path loss totals 15 dB, with a required 3 dB reserve under this project's design rule. Ignore other penalties only for this calculation. These figures are not equipment recommendations or a complete acceptance test.

PEOPLE / Ivo: Optical network planner | Nadia: Deployment manager

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

10

WORD + PHRASE BANK

Receiver sensitivity / power budget / wavelength / path loss / received power / engineering margin

- 01 **Nadia:** The spreadsheet predicts minus eighteen dBm at the receiver. That is above its minus-twenty sensitivity. Can I mark the design as meeting our margin requirement?
- 02 **Ivo:** Not yet. The ¹ _____ is seventeen decibels before reserve. Subtracting the planned fifteen-decibel loss leaves only two decibels of margin.
- 03 **Nadia:** The project requires three. So a result above the receiver's threshold is not enough to satisfy the specified reserve.
- 04 **Ivo:** Correct. The ² _____ must be fourteen decibels or less for this seventeen-decibel budget to retain the three-decibel reserve.
- 05 **Nadia:** I want to check the signs aloud. Minus three, less fifteen, gives minus eighteen dBm. We do not subtract minus fifteen and get positive twelve.
- 06 **Ivo:** Exactly. That is the predicted ³ _____. The loss is a positive fifteen-decibel reduction, not a negative power reading.
- 07 **Nadia:** Then the current design is short of our required reserve by one decibel. It is not three decibels short and not completely without signal.
- 08 **Ivo:** Right. Call it insufficient ⁴ _____ under the stated rule. Do not turn that calculation into a claim that the installed service has already failed.
- 09 **Nadia:** Could the team simply use a stronger typical transmitter value from another sheet? It would make the result look better.
- 10 **Ivo:** We need the applicable minimum and conditions for the chosen equipment. Replacing the agreed basis with a favorable typical value would hide the shortfall rather than resolve it.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 79.

- 11 **Nadia:** The receiver figure also needs to apply at the specified performance, not merely show the faintest light the device can detect.
- 12 **Ivo:** Yes. ⁵ _____ belongs with its performance criterion. The calculation needs compatible equipment assumptions, not whichever two numbers produce the largest budget.
- 13 **Nadia:** We have only checked the low-power side here. A complete design also needs to consider whether maximum input could overload the receiver.
- 14 **Ivo:** Correct. More optical power is not automatically better. The receiver's permitted maximum, other penalties, and actual operating conditions require their own checks.
- 15 **Nadia:** Before I ask for a revised route estimate, what needs to stay attached to the loss figure so we compare like with like?
- 16 **Ivo:** Keep the ⁶ _____, fiber type, component assumptions, and reference endpoints. A result for another test condition is not automatically interchangeable with this one.
- 17 **Nadia:** I will return the design for a documented revision rather than edit the reserve down to two. The three-decibel requirement remains unchanged.
- 18 **Ivo:** Good. The responsible engineer can assess a suitable design change. This conversation does not authorize swapping components or changing an operating link.
- 19 **Nadia:** My planning note will say seventeen budget, fifteen planned loss, two remaining, and three required: one decibel short of the stipulated margin.
- 20 **Ivo:** That is the useful summary. Keep predicted and measured results separate, and leave final acceptance to the specified engineering and testing process.

10

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 102

1. power budget | 2. path loss | 3. received power | 4. engineering margin | 5. Receiver sensitivity | 6. wavelength

Calculate the remaining reserve

F Say it in a new situation

Fictional link: minimum transmit power -2 dBm, receiver sensitivity -18 dBm, planned path loss 12 dB. Required reserve is 3 dB. Ignore other penalties for this arithmetic only.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

12 / 16 / 1 / 4

Planner: The power budget before reserve is ¹ _____ dB.

Manager: The stipulated path loss is ² _____ dB.

Planner: The margin remaining after that loss is ³ _____ dB.

Manager: That exceeds the required reserve by ⁴ _____ dB.

10

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 102

1. 16 | 2. 12 | 3. 4 | 4. 1

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.
2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.
3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

Eight numbers move; four must stay

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Clarify a partial number transfer using explicit scope, carrier records, and distinct authorization and completion milestones.

Fictional U.S. account: twelve numbers, abbreviated by endings 0100-0111. Authorization covers 0100-0107 only; 0108-0111 must stay. The draft wrongly selects a full port. Billing number 0100 is moving. The requested 22 October date has no carrier commitment. Complete identifiers are in the approved record; actual requirements are provider-specific.

PEOPLE / Yara: Porting coordinator | Scott: Customer telecom administrator

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

completion confirmation / letter of authorization / partial port / billing telephone number / firm order commitment / number inventory

11

- 01 **Yara:** Before I submit the transfer, the form says full port, but your signed list names eight of twelve numbers. Should the other four remain with the current provider?
- 02 **Scott:** Yes. Our ¹ _____ is clear: endings zero-one-zero-zero through zero-one-zero-seven move; zero-one-zero-eight through zero-one-one-one stay. The form is wrong.
- 03 **Yara:** That is eight moving and four staying. I will reconcile the complete verified numbers in the actual request; these shortened endings are only for this discussion.
- 04 **Scott:** The ² _____ covers those eight only. Please do not expand it to all twelve to make the full-port field agree with the draft.
- 05 **Yara:** Agreed. This is a ³ _____, so the retained services need explicit handling in the request and with the current provider.
- 06 **Scott:** The retained numbers are still in use. I also see that zero-one-zero-zero is the billing reference for the current account, even though that number is moving.
- 07 **Yara:** That ⁴ _____ needs attention. Confirm the provider's required arrangement for retaining those four services before we submit the request.
- 08 **Scott:** I can contact the current provider through our authorized channel and confirm the retained-service details. I will not choose a replacement billing number from memory.
- 09 **Yara:** Keep that response with the order. Also check any bundled-service dependencies; moving the numbers does not automatically resolve those arrangements.
- 10 **Scott:** The business wants the move on October twenty-second. Has the carrier accepted that date, or is it still just our preference?

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 82.

- 11 **Yara:** We have no ⁵ _____ yet. Correcting the scope and supplying the required records must not be reported as confirmation of the requested date.
- 12 **Scott:** I will keep the user notice provisional. They need a confirmed plan before changing their published contact arrangements or assuming the new routing is active.
- 13 **Yara:** And please do not cancel the existing services as a way to start the transfer. Coordinate the actual port and any later service changes through the providers' processes.
- 14 **Scott:** Understood. The four retained numbers are not a cancellation request, and the eight moving numbers still need their transfer coordinated.
- 15 **Yara:** When the scheduled work occurs, ⁶ _____ is another milestone. A commitment date alone will not tell us every number is routing correctly.
- 16 **Scott:** We will use the agreed ordinary calling checks for the moved and retained numbers. A successful call to the main number should not close all twelve checks.
- 17 **Yara:** Exactly. Follow the applicable service validation process and handle any emergency-calling requirements through qualified, coordinated procedures, not unplanned emergency test calls.
- 18 **Scott:** I will return the retained-service arrangement and complete number list through the approved channel. Credentials and transfer security codes do not belong in a widely shared email.
- 19 **Yara:** I will correct the draft to the authorized partial scope, verify the remaining requirements, and report the actual carrier response with its date and status.
- 20 **Scott:** Thank you. Our handoff is eight moving, four staying, billing-reference handling pending, and October twenty-second requested only. No wider transfer or cancellation is authorized by this conversation.

11

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 103

1. number inventory | 2. letter of authorization | 3. partial port | 4. billing telephone number | 5. firm order commitment | 6. completion confirmation

A partial request is not a full-account move

F Say it in a new situation

Fictional account: ten verified numbers. Signed authorization covers six; four must remain. The draft says full port, and the preferred 5 November date has no carrier commitment. Complete identifiers are held in the approved record.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

four / requested / six / partial

11

Administrator: The authorized number of transfers is ¹ _____.

Coordinator: The number of services that must remain is ² _____.

Administrator: The corrected request must describe a ³ _____ port.

Coordinator: The 5 November date remains ⁴ _____.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 103

1. six | 2. four | 3. partial | 4. requested

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.
2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.
3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

01 Briefing and language checks

Network Operations and Outage Bridges

A Briefing checks / page 4

1. What is the verified impact?

B. 120 broadband services in the East area

The record counts interrupted broadband services in one specified area, not people or equipment.

2. What does 09:40 Eastern represent?

C. The next public update

The team has committed to an update at that time, not to restoration.

3. What remains unconfirmed?

A. The root cause and restoration estimate

Fault isolation is ongoing and no restoration estimate has been verified.

D Language checks / page 9

1. Which public line is accurate?

C. We are investigating an interruption affecting 120 broadband services in the East area.

The accurate line preserves the verified service count, area, and investigation status.

2. A colleague says the recent change caused O73. What is the best response?

C. What evidence links that change to this incident?

Asking for a specific evidence link tests the claim without dismissing a potentially useful lead.

3. Which sentence correctly uses ETR?

C. No ETR has been verified; the next update is at 09:40 Eastern.

The sentence explicitly separates a restoration forecast from the communication schedule.

4. What should the handover preserve?

C. Impact, open questions, owner, and next update time

These items let the next team continue work without losing status or inventing certainty.

01 Conversation answers

Network Operations and Outage Bridges

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 10-11

1. service impact. Turn 2. Service impact names the verified effect on broadband service without treating the cause or restoration time as established.

2. affected-service count. Turn 4. Affected-service count preserves the measured unit; one customer may have several services and a service may serve several people.

3. Fault isolation. Turn 6. Fault isolation is the ongoing process of locating the fault; a recent change remains a hypothesis until evidence connects it.

4. ETR. Turn 8. ETR means estimated time of restoration; the team has no verified forecast and must not substitute a communication deadline.

5. status cadence. Turn 10. Status cadence is the agreed update frequency, giving customers a useful communication expectation without inventing technical progress.

6. incident commander. Turn 12. Incident commander identifies the person coordinating response priorities and keeping the bridge's decisions, owners, and updates aligned.

7. incident timeline. Turn 14. Incident timeline records events chronologically, preserving the source and timing of changes in the service picture.

8. monitoring window. Turn 16. Monitoring window is the defined observation period used to establish stable service rather than relying on a single favorable reading.

9. restoration. Turn 18. Restoration is the verified return of service; it should be reported from the agreed evidence, not inferred from optimism.

10. post-incident review. Turn 20. Post-incident review examines the response and causes after the incident; it is distinct from an immediate service-status update.

F Transfer conversation

Page 12

1. R16

Lead: "The incident reference is R16."

R16 is the identifier supplied for this separate interruption.

2. 45 voice services

Agent: "The verified impact is 45 voice services."

The record counts affected voice services, not individual users or broadband lines.

3. 14:30 Central

Lead: "Our next update is at 14:30 Central."

This is the stated communication time and includes its time zone.

4. unverified

Agent: "The restoration estimate remains unverified."

No verified restoration estimate is supplied, so the update time cannot replace it.

02 Briefing and language checks

Fiber Deployment and Construction Coordination

A Briefing checks / page 13

1. Which milestone is complete?

B. Physical installation of route F24

Physical installation is confirmed, while the required acceptance items remain pending.

2. Which item has been supplied?

C. An OTDR trace

The contractor supplied the trace and photographs, not the three outstanding items.

3. What can be said about inspection?

A. Sign-off is pending; no failure is reported.

Pending sign-off establishes neither a successful inspection nor a reported inspection failure.

D Language checks / page 18

1. Which schedule note is supported?

D. F24 installed; acceptance pending.

The note states the completed physical work while preserving the unresolved acceptance status.

2. What should Hana request?

C. The missing reports, drawings, and inspection sign-off with owners and dates

The request addresses the three actual dependencies and makes follow-up responsibility clear.

3. Which sentence handles the inspection accurately?

B. We are awaiting sign-off; no failure has been reported.

The evidence supports pending approval but contains no report of an inspection failure.

4. What is the best response to the OTDR argument?

C. The trace is useful, but the agreed insertion-loss report is still required.

The response recognizes the supplied evidence without replacing a distinct agreed acceptance requirement.

02 Conversation answers

Fiber Deployment and Construction Coordination

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 19-20

1. fiber route. Turn 2. Fiber route identifies the specific installed cable path; completing its physical work does not establish every acceptance milestone.

2. OTDR. Turn 4. OTDR identifies the instrument used to produce the supplied trace; that trace does not satisfy every separate handover requirement.

3. Insertion loss. Turn 6. Insertion loss describes optical power reduction through the link; its required report is distinct from the supplied event trace.

4. as-built drawing. Turn 8. As-built drawing records the actual constructed arrangement rather than simply repeating the planned design.

5. inspection sign-off. Turn 10. Inspection sign-off is the recorded approval still pending; its absence does not establish that the inspection failed.

6. acceptance criteria. Turn 12. Acceptance criteria are the agreed conditions for accepting the route, rather than a general impression that construction looks finished.

7. handover package. Turn 14. Handover package brings together the agreed documents and evidence; tracking its missing items makes the transfer dependency explicit.

8. fiber strand. Turn 16. Fiber strand identifies the individual optical fiber tested, preventing a result for one strand from being assumed to cover another.

9. ready for service. Turn 18. Ready for service is a defined readiness status; it should follow the required evidence and authorization, not physical installation alone.

10. demarcation point. Turn 20. Demarcation point defines the responsibility boundary at handover, helping the receiving team understand exactly what is being transferred.

F Transfer conversation

Page 21

1. C18

Coordinator: "The route identifier is C18."

C18 is the route named in this separate handover record.

2. physical installation

Contractor: "The completed milestone is physical installation."

The record confirms installation, not completion of every acceptance requirement.

3. inspection sign-off

Coordinator: "The outstanding approval is inspection sign-off."

Drawings and loss results are supplied, leaving the stated inspection approval pending.

4. pending

Contractor: "The acceptance status remains pending."

The local acceptance condition has not been met while the required sign-off remains outstanding.

03 Briefing and language checks

Wireless Capacity and Coverage

A Briefing checks / page 22

1. What does the coverage map establish here?

B. Reported signal availability across the seating area

The map concerns signal availability and does not establish end-to-end performance or cause.

2. What were the two observed speeds?

D. 80 Mbps quiet and 5 Mbps busy

The brief records those two readings under different, uncontrolled operating conditions.

3. What is not yet justified?

A. A claim that extra access points will solve the issue

The evidence does not isolate the limiting factor or establish the effect of additional access points.

D Language checks / page 27

1. Which explanation is most accurate?

A. Signal availability and busy-hour throughput measure different things.

The explanation distinguishes coverage from achieved performance without inventing a cause.

2. What should Jordan say about adding access points?

C. It is an option to assess after identifying the constraint.

Additional access points may help in some designs, but the current evidence does not establish that result.

3. Which comparison is more useful?

A. Documented tests with radio and backhaul measurements from the same periods

Matched context helps the team distinguish competing explanations for the observed slowdown.

4. What is supported by the two readings?

B. Measured throughput differed between the two tests.

The readings establish a difference in observed throughput, not a population-wide result or a specific cause.

03 Conversation answers

Wireless Capacity and Coverage

03

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 28-29

- 1. Coverage.** Turn 2. Coverage concerns signal availability across an area; it does not establish the throughput each connected passenger will receive.
- 2. throughput.** Turn 4. Throughput is the achieved data-transfer rate measured in each test, unlike a signal map or nominal link specification.
- 3. capacity.** Turn 6. Capacity describes how much demand the system can support under specified conditions, not merely whether a signal reaches a device.
- 4. bottleneck.** Turn 8. Bottleneck is the limiting point in the service path; identifying it helps determine whether an equipment proposal addresses the actual constraint.
- 5. client density.** Turn 10. Client density measures the concentration of devices in the area, adding demand context that a signal map alone does not show.
- 6. airtime.** Turn 12. Airtime is the shared wireless-channel time consumed by transmissions; high demand can reduce the opportunity available to each active client.
- 7. channel utilization.** Turn 14. Channel utilization measures how busy a wireless channel is, helping assess radio conditions without declaring interference proven in advance.
- 8. backhaul.** Turn 16. Backhaul carries traffic onward from the access network; a constraint there can affect performance even when radio coverage is adequate.
- 9. baseline.** Turn 18. Baseline is a reference observation for comparison; a quiet-period result does not automatically represent performance under peak demand.
- 10. test conditions.** Turn 20. Test conditions record the circumstances behind measurements, making the comparison interpretable and reducing unsupported claims about cause.

F Transfer conversation

Page 30

1. 60 Mbps

Manager: "The 08:00 throughput reading was 60 Mbps."

Sixty megabits per second is the early test result stated in the record.

2. 12 Mbps

Engineer: "The 16:00 throughput reading was 12 Mbps."

Twelve megabits per second is the later observed result, not a guaranteed rate for all users.

3. signal availability

Manager: "The map describes signal availability."

The supplied map concerns coverage rather than measured traffic capacity or cause.

4. unconfirmed

Engineer: "The cause of the difference remains unconfirmed."

Missing demand and backhaul observations prevent the readings alone from establishing the cause.

04 Briefing and language checks

Provisioning and Service Activation

04

A Briefing checks / page 31

1. Which circuit does Omar request?

C. CP-205 for the upstairs studio

Omar identifies the upstairs studio service as CP-205 during the clarification.

2. What is the status of the 7 October window?

C. Requested, not yet confirmed

Lina has not checked the resources, approvals, and dependencies needed to confirm the window.

3. Which service is outside the stated request?

A. CP-204

No change to CP-204 is authorized by the clarified request.

D Language checks / page 36

1. Which clarification is most useful first?

D. Which circuit reference at 18 Cedar Plaza is the request for?

The address is ambiguous because two distinct circuits serve the same premises.

2. Which read-back is correct?

C. A77 requests CP-205 on 7 October, 18:00-20:00 Eastern; confirmation is pending.

The read-back preserves the order, circuit, date, time zone, and unconfirmed scheduling status.

3. What is overpromised?

C. There will definitely be no interruption.

The supplied information does not establish that the activation can occur without interruption.

4. What should Lina do after clarification?

A. Complete the relevant checks and return the scheduling decision.

Clarification completes missing request information but does not replace approval or scheduling checks.

04 Conversation answers

Provisioning and Service Activation

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 37-38

- 1. service order.** Turn 2. Service order identifies the recorded request; it must be distinguished from the individual circuit that the request will affect.
- 2. circuit reference.** Turn 4. Circuit reference identifies the precise service to act on, preventing the shared address from being treated as sufficient identification.
- 3. read-back.** Turn 6. Read-back repeats the key details so both people can confirm or correct the same service, location, and scope.
- 4. requested date.** Turn 8. Requested date records the customer's preference before the provider completes the checks needed to confirm a commitment.
- 5. activation window.** Turn 10. Activation window is the specified period for enabling the service; in this conversation it remains a request rather than an approved slot.
- 6. dependency.** Turn 12. Dependency is a prerequisite for the activation, so identifying it matters before the requested date becomes a confirmed schedule.
- 7. order validation.** Turn 14. Order validation checks completeness and consistency; it resolves ambiguities rather than allowing staff to infer a broader scope.
- 8. service identifier.** Turn 16. Service identifier keeps the conversation tied to the exact service while performance or continuity expectations are checked separately.
- 9. committed date.** Turn 18. Committed date is a formally confirmed schedule, unlike the requested date that the customer has supplied during this call.
- 10. time zone.** Turn 20. Time zone removes ambiguity for teams in different locations; Eastern is part of the requested window, not an optional detail.

F Transfer conversation

Page 39

1. MS-310

Specialist: "The requested circuit is MS-310."

MS-310 identifies the west-office service named in the request.

2. 12 October

Coordinator: "The requested date is 12 October."

The customer specifies this date, but the scheduling checks remain incomplete.

3. 09:00-11:00 Pacific

Specialist: "The requested time window is 09:00-11:00 Pacific."

The supplied window includes Pacific time, preventing a cross-location scheduling ambiguity.

4. not yet confirmed

Coordinator: "The scheduling status is not yet confirmed."

Incomplete scheduling checks mean the requested window is not a committed appointment.

04

05 Briefing and language checks

Field Service and Dispatch

A Briefing checks / page 40

1. What symptom is reported?

A. Video calls drop on two Wi-Fi laptops between 18:00 and 20:00.

The customer reports a specific application, connection type, device count, and time pattern.

2. What is unknown?

D. Wired performance

No wired-performance observation has been supplied during the clarification.

3. What does Friday 13:00-15:00 represent?

D. Customer availability, not a booked appointment

Erin has offered access availability, but dispatch has not confirmed a booking.

D Language checks / page 45

1. Which ticket summary preserves the report?

D. Customer reports video-call drops on two Wi-Fi laptops from 18:00 to 20:00; wired status unknown.

The summary retains the observed scope, timing, source, and untested wired condition.

2. Which question provides useful clarification?

A. Are the affected laptops using Wi-Fi or a cable?

Connection type helps describe and investigate the symptom without asking the customer to invent a diagnosis.

3. Which appointment statement is accurate?

B. Friday 13:00-15:00 is your availability; booking is not yet confirmed.

The statement distinguishes offered access from a confirmed visit and avoids guaranteeing repair.

4. What should remain marked unknown?

C. Wired performance

The clarification contains no wired test or observation, so its status remains unknown.

05 Conversation answers

Field Service and Dispatch

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 46-47

1. symptom. Turn 2. Symptom describes the observable video-call interruption without assuming which component or network segment caused it.

2. affected devices. Turn 4. Affected devices limits the report to the two laptops, not every device at the premises.

3. Wired performance. Turn 6. Wired performance remains untested; no observation establishes either success or failure.

4. symptom window. Turn 8. Symptom window identifies the reported occurrence period, which is separate from the customer's availability for a field visit.

5. customer-reported. Turn 10. Customer-reported attributes the observations to Erin rather than presenting them as independently verified findings.

6. access contact. Turn 12. Access contact names the person coordinating entry so the technician can reach the relevant work area.

7. customer availability. Turn 14. Customer availability is the offered access period; it does not become an appointment until scheduling is confirmed.

8. appointment window. Turn 16. Appointment window specifies the visit arrangement, not a deadline guaranteeing fault resolution.

9. work order. Turn 18. Work order carries the task and facts to the field team; the timing helps them prepare.

10. dispatch. Turn 20. Dispatch coordinates the visit using the clarified symptoms, access details, and scheduling status.

F Transfer conversation

Page 48

1. one wired desk phone

Dispatcher: "The affected device is one wired desk phone."

The report identifies one wired phone, not every phone or a wireless laptop.

2. 10:00-11:00

Customer: "The reported symptom window is 10:00-11:00."

This is when the dropouts occur, not the offered access period.

3. not checked

Dispatcher: "Other-phone performance is not checked."

No observations for other phones are supplied, so their performance remains unverified.

4. Monday 15:00-17:00

Customer: "My access availability is Monday 15:00-17:00."

This is offered availability only; the separate record says no appointment has been booked.

05

06 Briefing and language checks

Regulatory and Emergency Services

A Briefing checks / page 49

1. What is wrong with the draft assurance?

C. It promises availability despite dependencies identified in the product record.

The absolute assurance conflicts with known equipment and broadband dependencies and lacks the required review.

2. What should happen next?

D. Verify the limitations and route revised wording through the responsible review process.

The task requires verified service-specific content and review, not unsupported publication or an emergency test call.

3. What jurisdiction and service context are stated?

C. U.S. interconnected VoIP

The brief expressly identifies the U.S. interconnected-VoIP context, which limits the regulatory discussion.

D Language checks / page 54

1. Which revision approach is appropriate?

A. Replace the absolute with verified service-specific limitations and obtain review.

The appropriate approach preserves verified facts, relevance, readability, and the required review.

2. Which statement should be challenged?

C. Backup power means emergency calling can never fail.

Backup power alone does not establish an unconditional guarantee across all equipment and network conditions.

3. What does an approved wording record need?

D. The exact version and documented review outcome

Version-specific records distinguish actual authorization from an informal or unrelated review.

4. What does this scenario authorize?

A. Review of customer-notice language, not an emergency test call

The exercise concerns communication review and explicitly excludes using emergency calling as a test.

06 Conversation answers

Regulatory and Emergency Services

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 55-56

1. absolute assurance. Turn 2. Absolute assurance is an unconditional promise unsupported by the documented equipment and broadband dependencies.

2. service limitation. Turn 4. Service limitation identifies a condition affecting availability; customers need that condition to understand the service.

3. applicability. Turn 6. Applicability asks whether the requirement and wording fit this particular service, jurisdiction, and operating arrangement.

4. plain-language notice. Turn 8. Plain-language notice makes the facts understandable while preserving the relevant dependencies and consequences.

5. backup power. Turn 10. Backup power is an alternative power source; its existence alone does not guarantee the entire service path remains available.

6. prominence. Turn 12. Prominence concerns whether customers notice the limitation; a contradictory headline can undermine the notice.

7. publication hold. Turn 14. Publication hold prevents the unreviewed notice from being released while technical facts and applicable requirements are checked.

8. version control. Turn 16. Version control identifies the reviewed document and prevents an obsolete draft from being mistaken for approved text.

9. review record. Turn 18. Review record documents the version, responsible reviewers, and outcome, preserving evidence of what was actually checked and approved.

10. approved wording. Turn 20. Approved wording is language authorized for the identified service and version after the required review, not merely a plausible draft.

F Transfer conversation

Page 57

1. never fails

Editor: "The unsupported absolute is never fails."

Never fails promises an unconditional result that the supplied product facts do not establish.

2. power dependency

Reviewer: "The identified technical condition is a power dependency."

The product record explicitly identifies dependence on power as a condition to explain.

3. product and compliance

Editor: "The required reviewers are product and compliance."

Both teams are named in the local release process and neither has approved the draft.

4. not approved

Reviewer: "The release status is not approved."

The stated approvals are absent, so revision work alone cannot authorize release.

07 Briefing and language checks

Customer Churn and Service Recovery

A Briefing checks / page 58

1. What has Leila reported?

C. Three broadband interruptions this week

Leila reports three interruptions, while the records have not established a shared technical cause.

2. What can Mateo commit to?

B. A coordinated review and an update at 16:00 Central the next day

Mateo can own the review and communication, but no permanent repair or compensation result is established.

3. What should happen if Leila wants to cancel?

D. Provide the applicable cancellation route without withholding support.

The brief requires preserving access to the actual cancellation process rather than using support as leverage.

D Language checks / page 63

1. Which response best handles never again?

D. I cannot guarantee that, but I will coordinate the review and update you tomorrow at 16:00 Central.

The response honestly limits the assurance while making a specific, accountable follow-up commitment.

2. Which credit statement is accurate?

C. I will submit the request; eligibility and amount remain unconfirmed.

No approved amount or eligibility decision is supplied, so the request must remain under review.

3. What should the technical summary say?

D. Three interruptions are reported; a shared cause is not yet established.

The summary distinguishes repeated impact from an unverified common-cause explanation.

4. How should cancellation be handled?

B. Explain the applicable route while continuing the review.

The customer should receive accurate process information without support being used as leverage.

07 Conversation answers

Customer Churn and Service Recovery

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 64-65

1. service recovery. Turn 2. Service recovery addresses the poor experience through concrete follow-up, not just an attempt to retain the account.

2. service history. Turn 4. Service history supplies the incident and interaction record needed to compare events before claiming they share the same cause.

3. case owner. Turn 6. Case owner identifies the person coordinating the review and communication, giving the customer a clear point of accountability.

4. reliability claim. Turn 8. Reliability claim concerns dependable service; the current evidence cannot support an unconditional no-recurrence guarantee.

5. follow-up commitment. Turn 10. Follow-up commitment specifies a controlled action and time, not a guaranteed repair deadline.

6. service credit. Turn 12. Service credit is a possible contract-related adjustment that requires review; the conversation does not establish eligibility or an approved amount.

7. goodwill adjustment. Turn 14. Goodwill adjustment is a discretionary commercial route, which may have different conditions and authority from an SLA-related credit.

8. cancellation request. Turn 16. Cancellation request concerns ending service; access to that process must not depend on withdrawing the complaint.

9. common cause. Turn 18. Common cause means an explanation shared by the incidents; repeated customer impact alone does not establish that technical relationship.

10. complaint escalation. Turn 20. Complaint escalation provides a further review route for unresolved concerns, distinct from technical work, compensation review, and cancellation.

F Transfer conversation

Page 66

1. two

Agent: "The reported number of interruptions is two."

The record supplies two incidents, without establishing that they share a cause.

2. Sol

Customer: "The named review owner is Sol."

Sol is the agent explicitly assigned responsibility for coordinating this review.

3. Tuesday at 11:00 Mountain

Agent: "The next update is Tuesday at 11:00 Mountain."

The commitment specifies a day, time, and time zone for communication.

4. undecided

Customer: "The credit outcome remains undecided."

No eligibility or amount decision has been made for the service-credit request.

08 Briefing and language checks

Vendor and Equipment Lifecycle

A Briefing checks / page 67

1. What is Model A's purchase-price advantage?

C. \$10,000

Fifty thousand minus forty thousand gives a ten-thousand-dollar initial price difference.

2. How long is A's support gap within the plan?

A. 24 months during 2029-2030

Support ends before 2029, while planned operation continues through both 2029 and 2030.

3. What remains unknown?

C. The complete total cost of either option

Migration, maintenance, training, and disposal costs have not been supplied for either option.

D Language checks / page 72

1. Which financial claim is supported?

A. A costs \$10,000 less to purchase; total-cost savings are not established.

The quotation establishes the initial price difference but omits several lifecycle costs.

2. Which statement describes the gap correctly?

B. A is beyond its stated support date for all of 2029 and 2030.

A's support ends on 31 December 2028, leaving the next two planned operating years uncovered.

3. What should be checked before relying on renewal?

D. The applicable product notice and written support terms

Renewal cannot simply be assumed to override the specified product support boundary.

4. What remains necessary for Model B?

D. Technical-fit and full-cost assessment

B's longer support horizon addresses one comparison point but does not establish suitability or complete cost.

08 Conversation answers

Vendor and Equipment Lifecycle

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 73-74

- 1. purchase price.** Turn 2. Purchase price is the known initial acquisition cost, so the ten-thousand-dollar advantage is valid at that stage of the comparison.
- 2. LDOS.** Turn 4. LDOS is the last date of support stated by the vendor; continued operation does not extend that support milestone.
- 3. support gap.** Turn 6. Support gap is the period of intended operation after applicable support ends; here both 2029 and 2030 fall inside the operating plan.
- 4. support entitlement.** Turn 8. Support entitlement defines the actual rights under the applicable terms, not an assumed consequence of renewal.
- 5. support horizon.** Turn 10. Support horizon describes the period of available applicable support; B's stated date extends beyond the end of the current operating plan.
- 6. TCO.** Turn 12. TCO means total cost of ownership across a defined scope and period, including relevant costs beyond the initial purchase.
- 7. migration cost.** Turn 14. Migration cost covers moving to a replacement arrangement; its amount must be estimated, not assumed.
- 8. interoperability.** Turn 16. Interoperability asks whether the equipment works with required existing systems; a support date does not establish this.
- 9. exit plan.** Turn 18. Exit plan describes leaving or replacing the equipment arrangement before unsupported operation becomes necessary.
- 10. decision record.** Turn 20. Decision record preserves the comparison, evidence, assumptions, and approval so the final choice can be understood and revisited.

F Transfer conversation

Page 75

1. \$5,000

Buyer: "Model C's initial price advantage is \$5,000."

Twenty-nine thousand minus twenty-four thousand produces a five-thousand-dollar purchase difference.

2. 12 months

Planner: "C's support gap within the plan is 12 months."

Support ends before 2032, leaving that full planned operating year beyond the support boundary.

3. Model D

Buyer: "The model covering the stated support horizon is Model D."

Model D remains supported through 2033, which extends beyond the plan ending in 2032.

4. not established

Planner: "The complete total-cost comparison is not established."

Other lifecycle costs are unknown, so purchase prices do not establish the complete cost comparison.

08

09 Conversation answers

The call connects, but audio is one-way

E Extended conversation

Pages 76-77

1. SIP signaling. Turn 2. SIP signaling establishes and manages the session; the supplied INVITE, 200 OK, and acknowledgment do not prove intelligible audio reaches both people.

2. one-way audio. Turn 4. One-way audio describes the reported asymmetry: the office agent hears the caller, while the caller cannot hear the agent; it does not itself identify a failed component.

3. RTP. Turn 6. Real-time Transport Protocol carries media such as audio in this session; observing outbound RTP at one point does not establish remote delivery or audible content.

4. media path. Turn 10. The media path is the route taken by the audio packets; it must be investigated separately from the signaling exchange and at identified points in the relevant direction.

5. codec. Turn 14. A codec encodes and decodes the audio; successful signaling or packet presence alone does not prove the intended speech was correctly encoded, transported, and rendered.

6. fault summary. Turn 18. A fault summary combines the observed symptom, verified protocol events, observation points, and open questions without turning a partial test into an end-to-end success claim.

F Transfer exchange

Page 78

1. office

Engineer: The reported inaudible direction is caller to office.

The agent cannot hear the external caller, so caller-to-office audio is the affected direction.

2. audio

Support: Successful setup establishes signaling, not end-to-end audio.

The scenario explicitly distinguishes call establishment from whether both participants hear speech.

3. unchecked

Engineer: Office-side receipt is still unchecked.

Only the caller-side observation is supplied, and the office receiving side has not been checked.

4. T19

Support: Keep the record tied to test T19.

The stated identifier is T19, which links the direction report to the correct test attempt.

Background reading: [IETF RFC 3261: signaling and session establishment](#). The conversation is an original fictional teaching case.

10 Conversation answers

Enough light, but not enough margin

E Extended conversation

Pages 79-80

1. power budget. Turn 2. The power budget is the difference between minimum transmit power and receiver sensitivity: -3 minus -20 equals 17 dB before reserving design margin.

2. path loss. Turn 4. Path loss is the stipulated 15 dB reduction between transmitter and receiver; it is a relative level difference, unlike the absolute dBm power values.

3. received power. Turn 6. Received power is the absolute optical level at the receiver, here predicted as -3 dBm minus 15 dB, or -18 dBm; it is not a measured field result.

4. engineering margin. Turn 8. Engineering margin is the remaining allowance above receiver sensitivity after path loss; two decibels remains here, one decibel below the stipulated three-decibel requirement.

5. Receiver sensitivity. Turn 12. Receiver sensitivity is the minimum input associated with specified performance and conditions; a detection indication alone is not the same criterion.

6. wavelength. Turn 16. Wavelength identifies the optical operating or test condition; losses and equipment specifications must be compared on a compatible basis rather than mixing values from different conditions.

F Transfer exchange

Page 81

1. 16

Planner: The power budget before reserve is 16 dB.

Minus two minus negative eighteen gives a sixteen-decibel difference between transmit power and sensitivity.

2. 12

Manager: The stipulated path loss is 12 dB.

The separate path-loss input is twelve decibels, not an absolute power in dBm.

3. 4

Planner: The margin remaining after that loss is 4 dB.

Sixteen decibels of budget minus twelve of loss leaves four decibels of margin.

4. 1

Manager: That exceeds the required reserve by 1 dB.

Four available decibels of margin minus the three-decibel requirement leaves one decibel above the required reserve.

10

Background reading: [Fiber Optic Association: power and loss budgets](#). The conversation is an original fictional teaching case.

11 Conversation answers

Eight numbers move; four must stay

E Extended conversation

Pages 82-83

1. number inventory. Turn 2. The number inventory identifies all twelve services and their intended disposition; eight endings 0100-0107 move, while four endings 0108-0111 remain with the current provider.

2. letter of authorization. Turn 4. The letter of authorization records the customer's specified permission; here it covers eight named numbers and does not authorize transferring the remaining four.

3. partial port. Turn 5. A partial port moves only some numbers from the current account; the remaining services must be addressed explicitly rather than treated as included in a full transfer.

4. billing telephone number. Turn 7. The billing telephone number identifies the account for carrier processing; moving that number may require an agreed replacement or account arrangement to preserve retained services.

5. firm order commitment. Turn 11. A firm order commitment is the carrier's accepted scheduling milestone under its process; the requested 22 October date is not such a commitment in this record.

6. completion confirmation. Turn 15. Completion confirmation records that the transfer has actually reached its completed state; a scheduling commitment alone does not establish completed routing or all service checks.

F Transfer exchange

Page 84

1. six

Administrator: The authorized number of transfers is six.

The signed scope names six numbers, not all ten on the account.

2. four

Coordinator: The number of services that must remain is four.

Ten total numbers minus six authorized to move leaves four explicitly retained services.

3. partial

Administrator: The corrected request must describe a partial port.

Only some account numbers move, so a full-port designation conflicts with the authorized scope.

4. requested

Coordinator: The 5 November date remains requested.

No carrier commitment is supplied, so the preferred date cannot be described as confirmed or completed.

11

Background reading: [Bandwidth: partial ports, billing numbers, and commitment milestones](#). The conversation is an original fictional teaching case.

Find the move you need

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

01 Network Operations and Outage Bridges

Open the update: Here is the confirmed service impact.

Separate cause from impact: The interruption is confirmed; the cause is still under investigation.

Prevent confusion: That is an update time, not a restoration commitment.

Full phrase set: pages 7-8 | Dialogue: pages 10-11

02 Fiber Deployment and Construction Coordination

Name the completed task: Physical installation of F24 is complete.

Identify a missing item: The insertion-loss report is still outstanding.

Refer to the agreement: Let us check the handover package against the acceptance criteria.

Full phrase set: pages 16-17 | Dialogue: pages 19-20

03 Wireless Capacity and Coverage

Acknowledge the map: The map is useful for signal availability.

Keep evidence bounded: Those are two readings, not a complete performance profile.

Ask about devices: Were the device, location, and test method the same?

Full phrase set: pages 25-26 | Dialogue: pages 28-29

04 Provisioning and Service Activation

Identify the request: I am checking service order A77.

Confirm the location: CP-205 serves the upstairs studio.

Read back the request: You are requesting 7 October, 18:00-20:00 Eastern.

Full phrase set: pages 34-35 | Dialogue: pages 37-38

Keep the conversation productive

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

05 Field Service and Dispatch

Open the clarification: I want to add a clear symptom description to J31.

Identify the connection: Are those devices using Wi-Fi or a cable?

Avoid a diagnosis: That pattern does not yet establish a failed router.

Full phrase set: pages 43-44 | Dialogue: pages 46-47

06 Regulatory and Emergency Services

Identify the claim: The draft says that 911 always works.

Limit the context: We are reviewing a U.S. interconnected-VoIP service.

Keep the consequence clear: The customer needs to understand when calling may be limited or unavailable.

Full phrase set: pages 52-53 | Dialogue: pages 55-56

07 Customer Churn and Service Recovery

Acknowledge repetition: Three interruptions in one week have disrupted your team.

Avoid a common-cause assumption: We have not yet established that all three incidents share one cause.

Preserve the distinction: That is a progress update, not a guaranteed resolution time.

Full phrase set: pages 61-62 | Dialogue: pages 64-65

08 Vendor and Equipment Lifecycle

Acknowledge the saving: Model A is ten thousand dollars cheaper to purchase.

Quantify the gap: That leaves twenty-four months beyond support within our plan.

Qualify the alternative: Model B covers the stated support horizon, but technical fit still needs checking.

Full phrase set: pages 70-71 | Dialogue: pages 73-74

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

absolute assurance	remove an absolute assurance	51
acceptance criterion	confirm the acceptance criteria	14
acceptance test	arrange the acceptance test	33
access contact	identify the access contact	42
access point	identify the access point	23
activation	schedule activation	32
activation window	confirm the activation window	32
adjacent-channel interference	investigate adjacent-channel interference	23
affected device	identify affected devices	41
affirmative acknowledgment	record affirmative acknowledgment	51
airtime	measure airtime utilization	23
alarm correlation	perform alarm correlation	5
applicability	assess applicability	51
appointment window	confirm the appointment window	42
approved wording	use approved wording	51
as-built drawing	update the as-built drawing	14
availability	measure service availability	60
backhaul	check backhaul load	24
backup power	verify backup-power capabilities	50
bandwidth	specify the bandwidth	23
baseline	establish a baseline	24
blast radius	assess the blast radius	5
bottleneck	locate the bottleneck	24
broadband dependency	explain the broadband dependency	50

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

busy hour compare busy-hour results	24
cable plant document the cable plant	14
cancellation request record the cancellation request	60
capacity assess capacity	23
case owner name the case owner	59
change freeze observe the change freeze	6
channel utilization compare channel utilization	23
churn analyze customer churn	59
circuit reference read back the circuit reference	32
client density measure client density	24
closure note complete the closure note	42
co-channel interference assess co-channel interference	23
committed date verify the committed date	32
common cause establish a common cause	59
complaint escalation explain the complaint escalation route	60
compliance review request compliance review	51
concurrency assess peak concurrency	24
contention measure contention	24
coverage assess coverage	23
CPE verify the CPE details	33
customer availability confirm customer availability	41
customer notification review the customer notification	51
customer-reported label customer-reported symptoms	42
cutover coordinate the cutover	33

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

decision record	maintain the decision record	69
degradation	report service degradation	5
demarcation point	identify the demarcation point	15
dependency	identify the dependency	32
dispatch	request dispatch review	41
dispatchable location	verify dispatchable-location requirements	50
disposal cost	estimate disposal costs	69
downtime	reconcile downtime records	60
dropout	report a dropout	41
duct	identify the duct	15
E911	review E911 requirements	50
eligibility	assess credit eligibility	59
end-of-life	review the end-of-life announcement	68
end-of-sale	check the end-of-sale notice	68
equipment lifecycle	plan the equipment lifecycle	68
escalation path	follow the escalation path	6
ETR	validate the ETR	5
exclusion	check the exclusions	60
exit plan	prepare an exit plan	69
failover	assess failover status	6
fault code	verify the fault code	42
fault isolation	continue fault isolation	5
fiber route	identify the fiber route	14
fiber strand	identify the fiber strand	14

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

firmware review firmware support	69
first-time fix measure first-time-fix performance	42
fixed service determine fixed-service requirements	50
follow-up commitment record the follow-up commitment	59
goodwill adjustment request a goodwill adjustment	59
handoff confirm the handoff	33
handover package complete the handover package	15
heat map interpret the heat map	24
impact statement record the impact statement	59
incident commander identify the incident commander	5
incident timeline maintain the incident timeline	6
insertion loss record insertion loss	14
inspection sign-off obtain inspection sign-off	15
interconnected VoIP identify interconnected-VoIP obligations	50
intermittent fault document an intermittent fault	41
interoperability test interoperability	69
jitter monitor jitter	6
latency measure latency	6
LDOS verify the LDOS	68
line test review line-test results	42
loss budget check the loss budget	14
maintenance cost estimate maintenance costs	68
migration cost scope migration costs	68
monitoring window complete the monitoring window	6

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

no-access visit	avoid a no-access visit	42
NOC	notify the NOC	5
nomadic use	assess nomadic-use implications	50
non-fixed service	review non-fixed-service requirements	50
notice period	verify the notice period	60
number porting	confirm number-porting dependencies	33
ONT	identify the ONT	33
order fallout	resolve order fallout	33
order validation	complete order validation	32
OTDR	review the OTDR trace	14
outage bridge	join the outage bridge	5
packet loss	measure packet loss	5
patch panel	label the patch panel	14
plain-language notice	prepare a plain-language notice	51
planning horizon	align the planning horizon	68
port assignment	check the port assignment	33
portability	check portability requirements	33
post-incident review	schedule a post-incident review	6
power dependency	disclose the power dependency	50
prominence	assess the notice's prominence	51
provisioning	coordinate provisioning	32
PSAP	identify the relevant PSAP	50
publication hold	maintain the publication hold	51
pull section	document the pull section	15

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

punch list close the punch list	15
purchase price compare purchase prices	68
read-back perform a read-back	33
ready for service verify ready-for-service status	15
recurrence investigate recurrence	59
redundancy verify redundancy	6
registered location update the registered location	50
reinstatement inspect the reinstatement	15
relationship risk assess relationship risk	60
reliability claim substantiate a reliability claim	60
remediation plan confirm the remediation plan	60
remote diagnostics review remote diagnostics	42
renewal review renewal conditions	69
repair authorization confirm repair authorization	42
repeat dispatch review repeat-dispatch history	42
repeat incident review repeat incidents	59
reproducibility assess reproducibility	41
requested date record the requested date	32
residual value assess residual value	69
resource availability check resource availability	33
restoration confirm service restoration	5
retention handle a retention conversation	59
review record retain the review record	51
right of way confirm the right of way	15

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

risk acceptance	document risk acceptance	69
roaming	assess roaming behavior	24
rollback	request a rollback	6
root cause	verify the root cause	5
RSSI	record RSSI	23
security update	verify security-update availability	69
service address	verify the service address	32
service credit	review a service-credit request	59
service history	review the service history	60
service identifier	confirm the service identifier	32
service impact	confirm service impact	5
service limitation	explain a service limitation	51
service order	validate the service order	32
service profile	verify the service profile	33
service recovery	coordinate service recovery	59
site access	arrange site access	42
site survey	conduct a site survey	24
SLA	review the SLA	60
snag	record a snag	15
SNR	measure SNR	23
spares strategy	establish a spares strategy	69
splice enclosure	identify the splice enclosure	14
splice schedule	reconcile the splice schedule	14
status cadence	establish a status cadence	6

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

sticky client investigate a sticky client	24
support entitlement verify support entitlement	69
support gap quantify the support gap	68
support horizon compare support horizons	68
symptom describe the symptom	41
symptom window record the symptom window	41
TCO estimate TCO	68
technical fit assess technical fit	69
termination document the termination	14
termination charge check the termination charge	60
test condition control the test conditions	24
test report submit the test report	15
throughput measure throughput	23
time zone state the time zone	32
training cost include training costs	68
trouble ticket update the trouble ticket	41
version control maintain version control	51
VoIP describe the VoIP service	50
wayleave check the wayleave	15
wired connection check wired-connection evidence	41
wireless connection identify the wireless connection	41
WLAN assess the WLAN	23
work order review the work order	41
workaround evaluate a workaround	6

Original cases. Clear boundaries.

These are original fictional teaching conversations, not transcripts of real workers. Names, figures, organizations, and incidents are invented. Sources support terminology and communication aims, not the fictional results or an endorsement of this book.

[1] Electronic Code of Federal Regulations. 47 CFR 9.11: E911 service.

[Open the original source](#)

Current U.S. interconnected-VoIP emergency-calling requirements inform the notice-review case. Applicability, location obligations, and customer notifications require service-specific review. Checked 1 October 2026.

[2] Cisco. Wireless Network Solution Guide.

[Open the original source](#)

Background on wireless local-area networks, coverage, capacity, and performance. The book uses fictional Wi-Fi measurements, not current product specifications. Checked 1 October 2026.

[3] The Fiber Optic Association. Fiber Optic Cable Plant Installation.

[Open the original source](#)

Background on installation documentation and testing terminology. The dialogue does not replace technical acceptance specifications or field-safety requirements. Checked 1 October 2026.

[4] Cisco. End-of-Life Policy.

[Open the original source](#)

Background on distinct sales and support milestones. Fictional vendor dates illustrate comparison language; actual support depends on the applicable product notice and terms. Checked 1 October 2026.

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